













There's a Dinosaur in the Backyard

WHAT EVERY MODERN FAMILY NEEDS TO KNOW

DINOSAUR 60 SKILLS

THERE'S A DINOSAUR IN THE BACKYARD



EX LIBRIS

This book belongs to

_____
__

and their dinosaur, _____

There's a

DINOSAUR IN THE BACKYARD

60 Essential Skills for the Modern Dinosaur-Keeping Family

AN ILLUSTRATED HANDBOOK FOR FINDING, FEEDING AND KEEPING DINOSAURS

FUN BOOKS · HOME EDITION · 2026

There's a Dinosaur in the Backyard: 60 Essential Skills for the Modern Dinosaur-Keeping Family. Fun Books Home Edition, 2026.

Written and illustrated as an original work. The text and pictures in this book were created from scratch for this edition and are not copied from any other publication.

Please read before using this book. This is a work of humor. Dinosaurs have been extinct for about 66 million years, and none of the advice in this book has been tested on a real one. If you do find a dinosaur in your backyard, please telephone your local natural history museum before you do anything else, and do not attempt any of the skills in this book on bears, alligators, large dogs or the neighbors. Garden hoses, ladders, campfires and county fairs are real, though, so use ordinary good sense around them.

Printing tips. This book is laid out on US Letter (8.5 x 11 in) pages. Print double-sided, “flip on long edge”, at 100% scale. For a book that lies flat on the kitchen table, ask a copy shop for spiral or comb binding with a clear front and a heavy back cover.

Made with care for families who always suspected there was something in the backyard.

For every child who ever checked the backyard,
just in case.

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INTRODUCTION

How to use this book

There was a time, not so long ago, when a family could go a whole summer without finding a dinosaur in the backyard. Those days are over. Whether it came out of an egg in the squash patch, wandered down from the hills, or simply appeared one Tuesday beside the clothesline, the dinosaur is here, and it seems to be staying.

Most families are not ready. Nobody teaches dinosaur keeping in school. The pet shop has nothing in the right size. The veterinarian hangs up. This book is here to help. It gathers everything a sensible American family needs to know to find, feed, water, house, train and love a creature that weighs as much as the family car, or several family cars.

What you'll find inside. Sixty skills in nine chapters, each on a single page laid out the same way: a picture for every step, a short explanation of why it matters, a materials panel with what you'll need, and a notes panel with tips and the most important warnings. Colored tabs on the edge of every page tell you which chapter you're in, so you can find the right page quickly, even while something large is eating the porch.

How to use it. Don't wait for an emergency. Read the first chapter tonight, before anything hatches. Practice the calm approach on the family dog. Measure the garage. Introduce yourself to a large-animal veterinarian. Each skill you practice now is one less surprise later.

Start with the basics. If the dinosaur has already arrived, begin with Chapter 1 (the discovery), the feeding chart in Chapter 2, the garden hose in Chapter 3 and the dino-house in Chapter 4. Those four alone will put your household well ahead of the Hendersons, who are still hiding in the cellar.

The appendix at the back gathers the charts and checklists you'll reach for most: a dinosaur identification chart, a daily feeding and watering table, a list of backyard plants that are safe (and not), handy dinosaur conversions, starter-kit checklists, a family dinosaur card, a glossary, and a log for the skills your family has mastered.

A word on safety. Dinosaurs are large. Even a friendly one can step on a foot, swing a tail or sit on a sedan without meaning to. Watch for the boxes marked **Important**, keep children supervised, and remember that the best tool in dinosaur keeping is a calm voice and a full feed trough.

CHAPTERS AT A GLANCE

CHAPTER	WHAT IT COVERS	SKILLS
1. The Discovery	What to do when you look out the kitchen window and something looks back	6
2. Feeding Time	Keeping a very large appetite happy on a household budget	8
3. Water and Bath Time	Drinking, bathing and the great garden-hose question	7
4. Home and Shelter	Where it sleeps, where it waits, and where it is not allowed	6
5. Training and Manners	Sit, stay, and please stop eating the hedge	7
6. Health and First Aid	Sniffles, splinters and calling the very surprised veterinarian	6
7. Out and About	Taking your dinosaur into town, to the beach, and to school	7
8. Unusual Situations	Storms, snow, escapes, and the day there were suddenly twelve	7
9. Family Life	Chores, birthdays, holidays, and growing up together	6

CHAPTER ONE

1

THE DISCOVERY

What to do when you look out the kitchen window and something looks back



It usually happens on a Tuesday. The milk is warming, the radio is playing, and something with a tail the length of a station wagon is standing among the tomato plants. Do not panic. Thousands of American families have found a dinosaur in the backyard, and nearly all of them still have their backyards. This chapter takes you from the first startled gasp to a proper, neighborly introduction.

IN THIS CHAPTER

01 Confirming It's Really a Dinosaur
02 Saying Hello Without Becoming Lunch
03 Identifying Your Dinosaur at a Glance
04 Finding an Egg in the Vegetable Patch
05 Telling the Neighbors
06 When It Comes Through the Kitchen Window

HOW TO

CONFIRMING IT'S REALLY A DINOSAUR

SKILL 01 · THE DISCOVERY · 5 MINUTES · EASY

MATERIALS

- Your reading glasses



- A pair of binoculars



- A cup of hot coffee (for the nerves)



- A field guide to prehistoric animals



- A notepad and pencil



Before you telephone anyone, make sure. Many a father has roused the whole street over what turned out to be a large dog, a lawn ornament, or Uncle Walter in a rubber costume. A real dinosaur passes four simple tests.

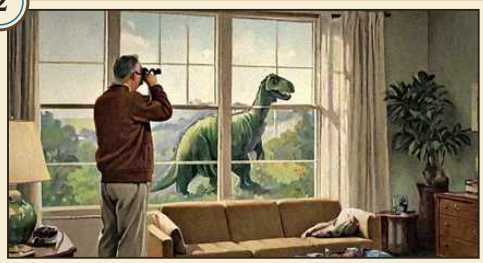
1



Put On Your Glasses

Most sightings are solved right here. If it still has scales and a tail, carry on.

2



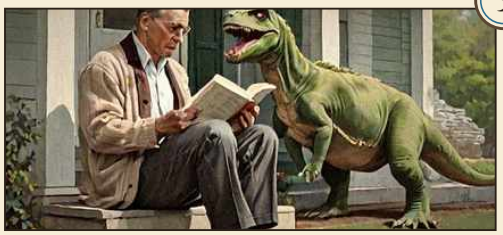
Look Through the Binoculars

Study it from indoors. Count the toes. Dogs have four; a tyrannosaurus has three big ones and a very confident expression.

Check the Field Guide

Compare what you see to the pictures. If it matches a page that says 'extinct', you have found something special.

3



4



Listen for the Rumble

A dinosaur's stomach growls loud enough to rattle the teacups. A lawn ornament's does not.

5



Look for Footprints

Step outside and inspect the lawn. Footprints large enough to bathe in are a reliable sign.

6



Write Down What You See

Note the time, size, color and mood. You will need this for the neighbors, the newspaper and possibly the insurance man.

NOTES

If it is wearing a zipper, it is Uncle Walter.

IMPORTANT

Never confirm a sighting by poking it with a broom handle.

HOW TO

SAYING HELLO WITHOUT BECOMING LUNCH

SKILL 02 · THE DISCOVERY · 15 MINUTES · MEDIUM

First impressions matter, especially to a creature with three horns. Approach as you would a new neighbor: smiling, unhurried, and carrying something to eat.

1



Move Slowly

Walk out at a gentle stroll. Running says 'I am a snack'. Strolling says 'I am the lady of the house'.

2



Stop at a Polite Distance

Halt about one car-length away and let it notice you. Most dinosaurs are more surprised than you are.

3



Speak Softly

Say something pleasant, such as 'Good morning, dear'. The words matter less than the tone.

MATERIALS



A plate of fresh lettuce



Your calmest Sunday voice



Comfortable flat shoes



A clean dish towel



A bucket of water

4



Offer the Plate

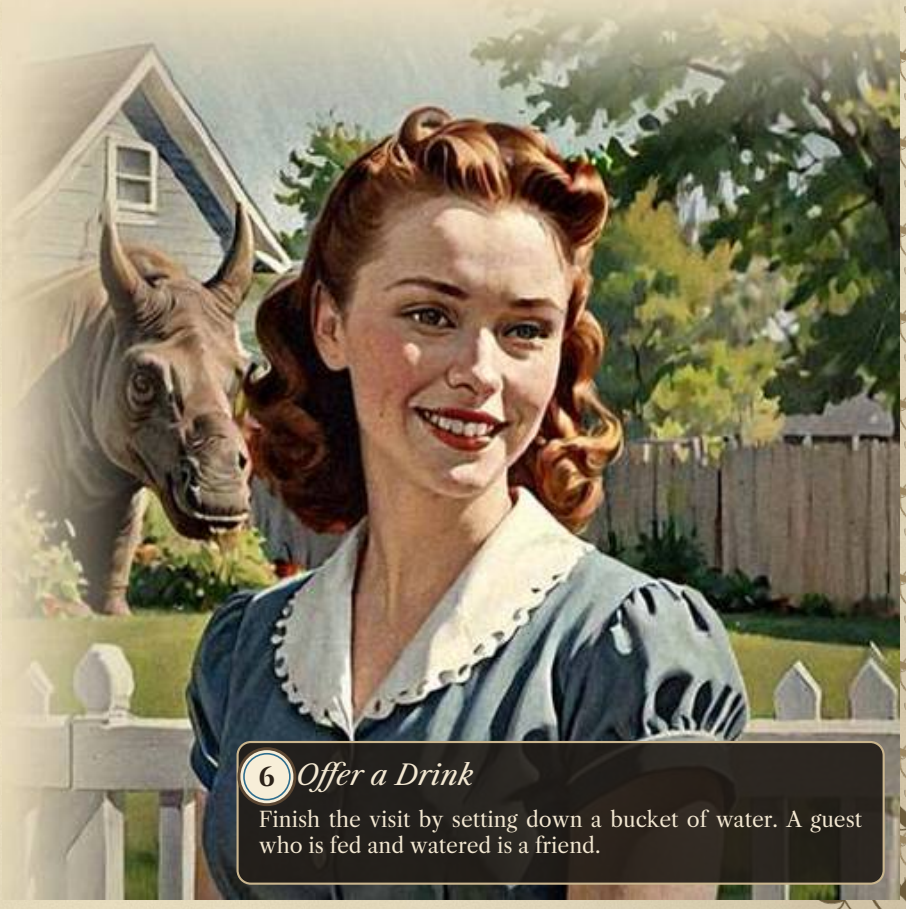
Set the lettuce on the ground and step back. Never hold food in your outstretched hand on the first visit.

5



Let It Sniff You

When it leans in to sniff, stand still and keep smiling. A snort is a compliment.



6 *Offer a Drink*

Finish the visit by setting down a bucket of water. A guest who is fed and watered is a friend.

NOTES

Wear an apron. Dinosaurs associate aprons with food, and food with friendship.

IMPORTANT

If the tail starts swishing hard, walk backward slowly and try again tomorrow.

HOW TO

IDENTIFYING YOUR DINOSAUR AT A GLANCE

SKILL 03 · THE DISCOVERY · 10 MINUTES · EASY

Knowing what kind of dinosaur you have tells you what it eats, how big it will get, and whether it should sleep in the garage or the county fairgrounds.

MATERIALS

- The family encyclopedia



- A tape measure (the long kind)



- A stepladder



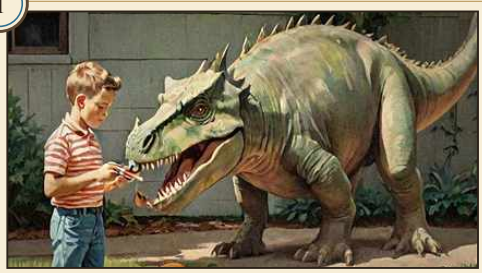
- Crayons and paper



- A magnifying glass



1



Look at the Teeth

Flat teeth mean salad. Pointed teeth mean meat. Either way, look from a respectful distance.

2



Count the Plates and Horns

Plates on the back: stegosaurus. Three horns: triceratops. A neck like a flagpole: brontosaurus.

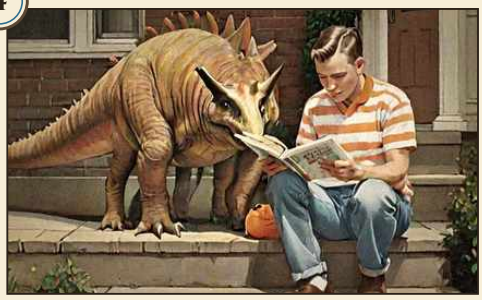
3

Measure It

Climb the stepladder and measure from the top of its head down. Ask it to hold still. It will not.



4



Check the Encyclopedia

Look it up under D. Then look under the species name, because D is mostly 'Ducks'.

5



Draw a Picture

A crayon drawing on the refrigerator helps the whole family learn what to call it.

6



Give It a Name

Choose a name that is easy to shout. 'Gerald' works well. 'Stegosaurus Stenops Junior' does not.

NOTES

See the Dinosaur Identification Chart in the appendix.

HOW TO

FINDING AN EGG IN THE VEGETABLE PATCH

SKILL 04 · THE DISCOVERY · 1 TO 3 WEEKS · MEDIUM

Sometimes the dinosaur has not arrived yet. It is waiting in an egg the size of a watermelon, tucked between the squash. Here is how to bring it into the world.

1



Check It Is an Egg

A dinosaur egg is speckled, warm and heavy. A watermelon is green and striped and makes a nicer salad.

2



Lift With Your Knees

These eggs weigh as much as a sack of potatoes. Bend your knees and keep your back straight.

3



Make a Warm Nest

Line a laundry basket with wool blankets and set the egg in the middle, pointed end down.

MATERIALS



A laundry basket



Two or three warm wool blankets



A desk lamp



A kitchen thermometer



A notebook for the hatching log

4



Keep It Toasty

Set a desk lamp above the basket. Aim for a steady 90 degrees, about like a July afternoon.

5



Listen for Tapping

After a week or two you will hear tapping. Don't help it out; the struggle makes it strong.

NOTES

Keep a log of temperatures and dates. It makes a wonderful baby book later.

IMPORTANT

Never put a dinosaur egg in the oven to 'speed things up'.



6 *Say Hello to the Hatchling*

When it pops out, it will imprint on the first face it sees. Make sure that face is smiling.

HOW TO

TELLING THE NEIGHBORS

SKILL 05 · THE DISCOVERY · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

The neighbors will find out. The only question is whether they hear it from you over a nice plate of cookies, or see it eating their hedge.

MATERIALS

- A plate of homemade cookies



- A handwritten note



- Your best manners



- A photograph of your dinosaur



- A good hat



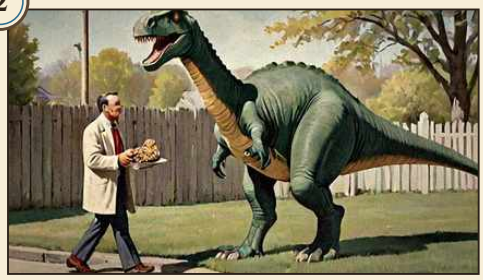
1



Choose Your Moment

Saturday mornings are best. People are relaxed, and the dinosaur is usually still asleep.

2



Bring Cookies

Nothing calms a neighbor like a warm cookie. Bring a full plate; some will be eaten by the dinosaur on the way.

3

Ring the Bell and Smile

Begin with 'Lovely weather' before you mention anything with a tail.



4



Show the Photograph

A photograph softens the news. So does saying 'he's a vegetarian' early in the conversation.

5



Leave a Note for Those Not Home

A friendly note in the mailbox prevents a scream when they open the curtains.

6



Invite Them Over

Ask the neighbors to Sunday supper to meet the newest member of the family.

NOTES

Mrs. Henderson down the street will tell everybody anyway. Tell her first.

HOW TO

WHEN IT COMES THROUGH THE KITCHEN WINDOW

SKILL 06 · THE DISCOVERY · 20 MINUTES · MEDIUM

A long-necked dinosaur will eventually discover that the kitchen window is where the good smells come from. Here is how to keep your composure and your casserole.

1



Stay Calm

A head in the window is curious, not hungry for you. Finish stirring the gravy.

2



Say a Firm 'No'

Use the same voice you use when Junior tracks mud across the floor.

3



Offer a Carrot Outside

Hold a carrot out of the window and slowly bring it back outdoors. The head follows the carrot.

MATERIALS


A large wooden spoon


A bunch of carrots


Kitchen curtains (sturdy)


A broom


A cool head

4



Close the Window Gently

Once the head is out, close the window. Never slam it; dinosaurs remember.

5



Draw the Curtains at Dinnertime

Out of sight is out of mind, at least until dessert.

NOTES

Keep a bowl of carrots by the window the way some families keep a bowl of mints by the door.

IMPORTANT

Hot pies cool on the windowsill at your own risk.



6 ### *Set Out a Supper Trough*

Give it its own supper outside at the same time as yours, and it will stop inviting itself in.

CHAPTER TWO

2

FEEDING TIME

Keeping a very large appetite happy on a household budget







A full-grown brontosaurus eats about as much in a day as the whole Elks Lodge eats in a year. Feeding a dinosaur is the single biggest job in dinosaur keeping, and the one most likely to put a strain on the grocery money. With planning, a good grocer and a large garden, it can be done cheerfully and even economically.

IN THIS CHAPTER

07 Planning a Week of Meals for a Plant-Eater
08 Feeding a Meat-Eater Without Losing the Mailman
09 Hand-Feeding a New Hatchling
10 Grocery Shopping for Four Tons of Lettuce
11 Keeping It Out of the Vegetable Garden
12 Dinner Party Etiquette With a Dinosaur Present
13 Treats and Training Biscuits
14 The Thanksgiving Turkey Problem

HOW TO

PLANNING A WEEK OF MEALS FOR A PLANT-EATER

SKILL 07 · FEEDING TIME · 1 HOUR · EASY

Plant-eaters are the easiest dinosaurs to keep, provided you never run out of plants. A written menu keeps the dinosaur content and the azaleas alive.

1



Weigh Your Dinosaur's Appetite

Watch how much it eats in one day. A triceratops of average size eats about 200 pounds of greens.

2



Write the Menu

Monday cabbage, Tuesday lettuce, Wednesday carrots. Variety keeps a dinosaur from wandering off to find its own.

3

Check the Grocery Circular

Buy what is on sale. Dinosaurs do not mind a slightly brown leaf.



4



Fill the Wheelbarrow

Load the day's meal into a wheelbarrow the night before so breakfast is quick.

5



Serve on Schedule

Feed at the same time every day. A dinosaur that knows when supper comes does not come looking for it.

6



Clean Up the Leftovers

Rake up the scraps afterward and put them on the compost pile.

NOTES

Ask the grocer for the outside cabbage leaves he would throw away. Most will give them free to a dinosaur family.

MATERIALS

- A pad of menu paper and a pencil



- The grocery circular



- A bushel basket



- A wheelbarrow



- A kitchen scale



HOW TO

FEEDING A MEAT-EATER WITHOUT LOSING THE MAILMAN

SKILL 08 · FEEDING TIME · DAILY · HARD

A meat-eating dinosaur is a serious responsibility. Fed well and on time, it is as gentle as a sheepdog. Fed late, it starts looking at the mailman in a thoughtful way.

MATERIALS


Twenty pounds of meatloaf


A long barbecue fork


A sturdy metal washtub


Thick leather work gloves


A dinner bell

1 *Order From the Butcher*



Set up a standing weekly order. Butchers love dinosaur families; they buy the odd cuts nobody else wants.

2 *Make a Giant Meatloaf*



A twenty-pound meatloaf is filling, cheap, and easy to serve. Leave out the onions.

3 *Ring the Dinner Bell*



Ring it every time you feed. Soon the bell itself will make your dinosaur sit and wait.

4 *Serve From the Tub*



Put the meal in a washtub and slide it out with your foot. Keep your hands to yourself.

5 *Step Back and Admire*



Stand clear while it eats. A tyrannosaurus at supper is not in a mood to chat.



6 *Never Skip a Meal*

If you go away, arrange a neighbor to feed it. Leave very clear instructions and the butcher's number.

NOTES

Feed the dinosaur before the mailman's usual time, never after.

IMPORTANT

Do not let children feed a meat-eater by hand. Use the washtub every time.

HOW TO

HAND-FEEDING A NEW HATCHLING

SKILL 09 · FEEDING TIME · EVERY 3 HOURS · MEDIUM

A newly hatched dinosaur is small, hungry and loud, rather like a new baby brother. For the first month it needs feeding every few hours, day and night.

1



Warm the Formula

Mix mashed peas with warm water until it flows like thin gravy. Test a drop on your wrist.

2



Fill the Bottle

Use a big bottle with a wide nipple. Hatchlings slurp.

3

Sit Comfortably

Settle into the rocking chair with the hatchling wrapped in flannel on your lap.



4



Feed Slowly

Let it drink at its own pace. Hatchlings that gulp get hiccups, and dinosaur hiccups are memorable.

5



Pat for the Burp

Hold it upright against your shoulder and pat gently. Stand by an open window.

6



Tuck It In

Lay it in a blanket-lined box near the stove for warmth. Night feedings are taken in turns.

NOTES

Write each feeding on a chart taped to the icebox so nobody feeds it twice.

MATERIALS

- A large glass baby bottle



- Warm mashed peas



- A soft flannel cloth



- A rocking chair



- A cardboard box with a blanket



HOW TO

GROCERY SHOPPING FOR FOUR TONS OF LETTUCE

SKILL 10 · FEEDING TIME · 1 MORNING · MEDIUM

There comes a day when the backyard garden is eaten to the dirt and Father must go to the market. It helps to know how to buy lettuce by the truckload without alarming the store.

MATERIALS


The family station wagon


A borrowed pickup truck


A shopping list


An envelope of cash


A strong back

1



Telephone Ahead

Call the grocer the day before. He will want to put in a special order with the farm.

2



Borrow a Truck

The station wagon holds about forty heads. You need about four thousand.

3



Drive to the Back Door

Go round to the loading dock where the crates come off the farm truck.

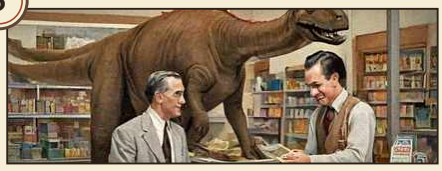
4



Load the Crates

Stack them tight so they do not slide on the corners. Lift with your legs.

5



Pay and Say Thank You

Grocers remember who pays promptly and who says thank you. Be both.



6 *Unload at Home*

Drive straight into the backyard. Your dinosaur will help unload, mostly by eating.

NOTES

Shop on Monday morning when the farm truck has just come in.

HOW TO

KEEPING IT OUT OF THE VEGETABLE GARDEN

SKILL 11 · FEEDING TIME · 1 WEEKEND · MEDIUM

To a dinosaur, a vegetable garden is a salad bar with a fence around it. These steps will help you share the yard without losing the beans.

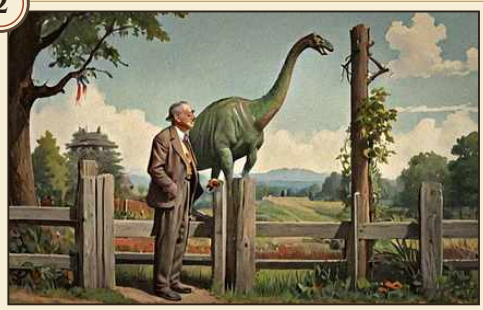
1



Plant a Decoy Patch

Plant a row of cabbages at the far end of the yard just for the dinosaur. It will usually choose the easy meal.

2



Put Up Tall Posts

Set fence posts at least ten feet high. Dinosaurs think a short fence is a step.

3

Stretch the Wire

Staple chicken wire between the posts. Two layers if it is a hungry week.



4



Hang Pie Tins

Shiny, clattering pie tins on strings make dinosaurs suspicious, and suspicious dinosaurs go elsewhere.

5



Build a Big Scarecrow

Dress it in Father's old suit. It will not frighten the dinosaur, but it will amuse the neighbors.

6



Inspect Each Morning

Walk the fence after breakfast and mend any holes before the dinosaur finds them.

NOTES
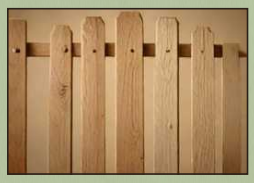
Marigolds along the fence smell awful to most dinosaurs.

MATERIALS

- Chicken wire, several rolls



- Wooden fence posts



- A hammer and fence staples



- A scarecrow (extra large)



- Pie tins and string



HOW TO

DINNER PARTY ETIQUETTE WITH A DINOSAUR PRESENT

SKILL 12 · FEEDING TIME · 1 EVENING · HARD

Guests will want to meet the dinosaur, and the dinosaur will want to meet the roast. With a little planning your dinner party can be the talk of the town for all the right reasons.

MATERIALS


The good china (or the second-best)


A seating chart


A separate dinosaur table, very sturdy


Two extra roasts


Large linen napkins

1



Plan the Seating

Seat the dinosaur at the end of the table nearest the door, and Aunt Edna at the other end.

2



Set a Dinosaur Place

A sturdy table on the patio with a big wooden bowl lets it join the party without joining the tablecloth.

3



Cook an Extra Roast

Always make one roast for the guests and one for the dinosaur. Make a third just in case.

4



Serve the Dinosaur First

A fed dinosaur is a well-behaved dinosaur. Serve its bowl before the guests sit down.

5



Tie on a Napkin

A big linen napkin tied round its neck makes a dinosaur feel like a guest and saves the patio.



6 ### *Keep Conversation Light*

Avoid topics such as meteors, museums and the Ice Age. They upset some dinosaurs.

NOTES

Seat the guest who laughs loudest farthest from the dinosaur. Loud laughter startles them.

IMPORTANT

Never serve a dinosaur from the good gravy boat. It will not give it back.

HOW TO

TREATS AND TRAINING BISCUITS

SKILL 13 · FEEDING TIME · 2 HOURS · EASY

A good treat is the secret of every well-trained dinosaur. Store-bought dog biscuits are far too small. Here is Grandmother's recipe for proper dinosaur biscuits.

1



Mix the Dough

Stir oatmeal, grated carrots and molasses into a stiff dough. Add water until it holds together.

2



Roll Into Balls

Make balls the size of a baseball. Smaller ones get swallowed before they are enjoyed.

3

Bake Until Hard

Bake on sheets at 300 degrees for an hour, until hard as a hockey puck.



4



Cool on the Sill

Set them on the windowsill to cool. Watch the windowsill.

5



Store in a Tin

Keep them in a tin with a tight lid on a high shelf. Dinosaurs can open most cupboards.

6



Reward Good Behavior

Give one biscuit for each good deed. Say 'Good dinosaur' every time.

NOTES

Plain carrots work as treats too, and keep the teeth bright.

MATERIALS

- Ten pounds of oatmeal



- A jar of molasses



- Grated carrots



- A big mixing bowl



- Baking sheets



- A cookie tin



HOW TO

THE THANKSGIVING TURKEY PROBLEM

SKILL 14 · FEEDING TIME · 1 HOLIDAY · HARD

Every dinosaur family remembers its first Thanksgiving, usually because the turkey disappeared. A few simple rules will keep the holiday bird on the holiday table.

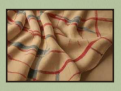
MATERIALS


Two turkeys (one is a decoy)


A carving knife


A locking pantry door


A lot of mashed potatoes


A tablecloth that can be replaced

1 *Buy Two Turkeys*



Buy one for the family and one for the dinosaur. Cook both. This is the whole secret.

2 *Lock the Pantry*



Store the family turkey behind a locked door until it goes in the oven.

3 *Serve the Dinosaur's Bird First*



Carry it out to the yard with ceremony. Dinosaurs appreciate a fuss.

4 *Carve Quickly*

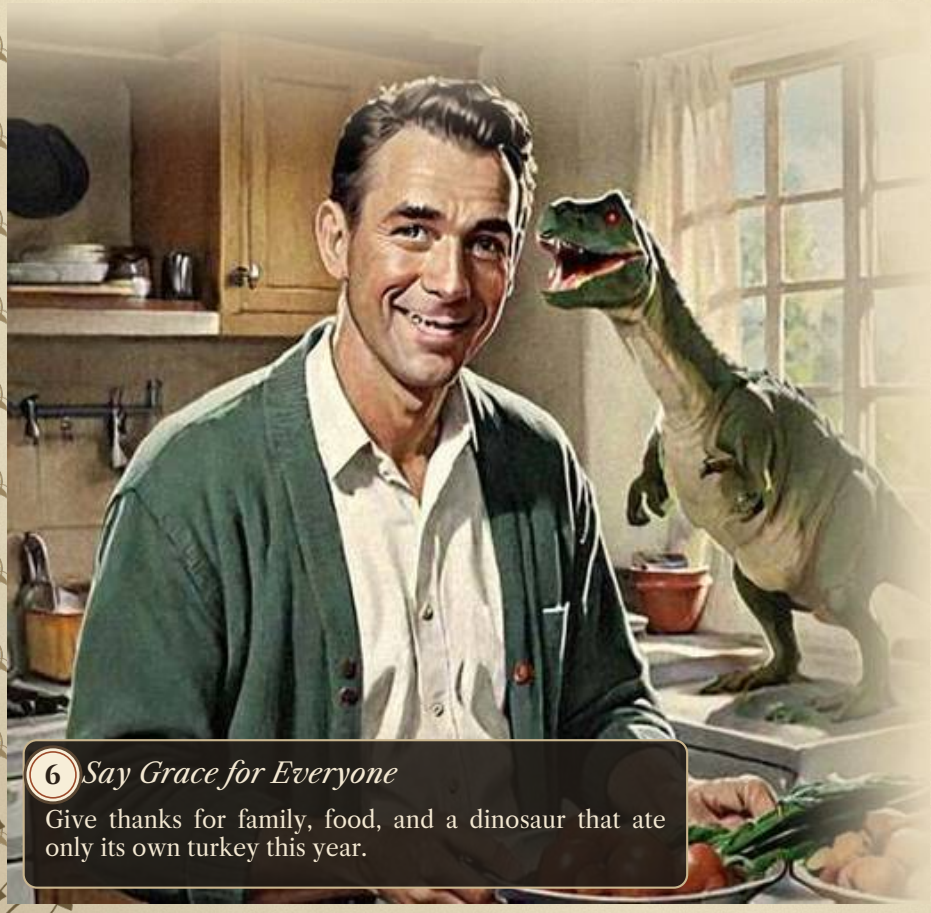


While the dinosaur is busy, carve the family turkey at once. Waste no time on speeches.

5 *Pass the Potatoes*



Mashed potatoes calm everyone, including dinosaurs, which are fond of them.



6 *Say Grace for Everyone*

Give thanks for family, food, and a dinosaur that ate only its own turkey this year.

NOTES

Some families have good luck giving the dinosaur a large ham instead. It looks less like the family bird.

CHAPTER THREE

3

WATER AND BATH TIME

Drinking, bathing and the great garden-hose question







A thirsty dinosaur will find water. It will find the birdbath, the neighbor's goldfish pond and, on one memorable occasion in Ohio, the town swimming pool. Better to bring the water to the dinosaur. This chapter covers drinking water, bath day, tooth brushing and the many uses of a good long garden hose.

IN THIS CHAPTER

15 Watering a Brontosaurus With the Garden Hose
16 Bath Day in the Washtub
17 The Backyard Swimming Pool Takeover
18 Brushing Teeth the Size of Bananas
19 Pedicures for Three-Toed Feet
20 Rainy Day Puddle Management
21 Keeping a Stegosaurus Cool in a Heat Wave

HOW TO

WATERING A BRONTOSAURUS WITH THE GARDEN HOSE

SKILL 15 · WATER AND BATH TIME · 30 MINUTES · EASY

A long-necked dinosaur drinks about 300 gallons a day, which is more than the kitchen tap can manage. The garden hose is your best friend.

MATERIALS

- A good long garden hose



- A brass spray nozzle



- A stepladder



- A large galvanized stock tank



- Rubber boots



1



Unroll the Hose

Unroll the whole length so there are no kinks. A kinked hose makes a dinosaur impatient.

2



Fill the Stock Tank

A big metal stock tank is the best drinking bowl. Fill it to the brim every morning.

Let It Drink

Stand back and let it drink. You will hear the gulps from the front porch.

3



4



Top It Up

Refill as it drinks. Most long-necks empty a tank twice before they are satisfied.

5



Offer a Shower

On hot days, spray a gentle mist up high. Long-necks love a shower on the back of the neck.

6



Roll Up and Put Away

Coil the hose neatly on its hook. Dinosaurs step on loose hoses and pop them.

NOTES

Turn the water on slowly. A sudden blast up the nose makes for a very wet afternoon.

HOW TO

BATH DAY IN THE WASHTUB

SKILL 16 · WATER AND BATH TIME · 1 HOUR · MEDIUM

Small dinosaurs can be bathed in a washtub, the same as a muddy beagle. They complain the same way too.

1



Fill With Warm Water

Warm, not hot. Dinosaurs are cold-blooded and fussy about bathwater.

2



Coax It In

Drop a treat in the water. Most small dinosaurs will hop in after it.

3



Soak and Scrub

Work up a lather with the brush, going with the scales, never against them.

MATERIALS


A galvanized washtub


A bar of mild soap


A long-handled scrub brush


Old towels, lots of them


A rubber apron

4



Rinse Well

Pour clean water from a pitcher until no suds are left between the scales.

5



Stand Back for the Shake

Every dinosaur shakes after a bath. Hold up a towel like a shield.



6 ### *Towel Dry*

Rub it dry in the sun. A clean dinosaur smells faintly of hay and new pennies.

NOTES

Bath day is best on washing day, when you are wet already.

IMPORTANT

Never use dish detergent. It dries out the scales and makes them flake.

HOW TO

THE BACKYARD SWIMMING POOL TAKEOVER

SKILL 17 · WATER AND BATH TIME · 1 SUMMER · MEDIUM

Install a swimming pool and the dinosaur will consider it a gift. Here is how to share it, or at least get a turn.

MATERIALS

- A schedule card for the pool



- A whistle on a lanyard



- A pool net



- A beach umbrella



- Sunglasses



1



Post a Schedule

Write out pool hours: mornings for dinosaurs, afternoons for people. Post it on the fence.

2



Blow the Whistle

A sharp whistle means 'everybody out'. Dinosaurs learn this quickly, though they do not like it.

3

Coax It Out With Lettuce

Hold up a head of lettuce at the shallow end. Wait patiently.



4



Skim the Pool

Use the net to scoop out leaves, twigs and the odd shed scale.

5



Take Your Turn

Enjoy your afternoon swim. The water will be warmer than usual.

6



Share on Hot Days

On the hottest days, give up and swim together. Dinosaurs make a fine shade.

NOTES

Duck-billed dinosaurs are natural swimmers. Brontosaurs are not and should stay in the shallow end.

IMPORTANT

A dinosaur in the pool raises the water level a great deal. Check the overflow.

HOW TO

BRUSHING TEETH THE SIZE OF BANANAS

SKILL 18 · WATER AND BATH TIME · 15 MINUTES · MEDIUM

A tyrannosaurus has about sixty teeth, each as long as a banana. Clean teeth mean fresh breath, and fresh breath means a happier household.

1



Wait for a Yawn

Brush after its afternoon nap, when it yawns. Never pry the jaws open.

2



Dip the Broom

Dip the broom in water and then in baking soda.

3



Brush Up and Down

Brush gently up and down along the front teeth. Leave the back teeth for a professional.

MATERIALS



A push broom (new, used only for teeth)



A tin of baking soda



A bucket of water



A stepladder



A big bunch of parsley

4



Rinse With the Hose

Spray clean water gently to rinse. Most dinosaurs enjoy this part.

5



Check for Stuck Bits

Look for lodged items: bones, sticks, a missing croquet mallet.

NOTES

Brush on the same day each week so it becomes routine for you both.

IMPORTANT

Never put your head in a dinosaur's mouth, however politely it is held open.



6 ### *Freshen the Breath*

Finish with a bunch of parsley. Your family will thank you.

HOW TO

PEDICURES FOR THREE-TOED FEET

SKILL 19 · WATER AND BATH TIME · 1 HOUR · EASY

MATERIALS

- A large wood rasp



- A bucket of warm soapy water



- A low stool



- A tin of hoof oil



- A radio playing soft music



Long walks on pavement wear a dinosaur's claws unevenly, and an overgrown claw clicks on the sidewalk all night. A pedicure fixes both.

1



Soak the Foot

Coax one foot at a time into a bucket of warm soapy water. Ten minutes softens the claws.

2



Dry It Off

Pat the foot dry with an old towel.

3

File the Claws

Use the wood rasp in long, smooth strokes. File a little at a time.



4



Oil the Scales

Rub hoof oil into the cracks on the sole to keep them supple.

5



Play Soft Music

Dinosaurs relax to music. Bing Crosby is a favorite.

6



Repeat for Each Foot

Four feet, three toes each. Pace yourself and take breaks for lemonade.

NOTES

Paint the claws only if the dinosaur is going somewhere special.

HOW TO

RAINY DAY PUDDLE MANAGEMENT

SKILL 20 · WATER AND BATH TIME · 1 RAINY DAY · EASY

Rain turns a backyard into a dinosaur's favorite mud bath. Here is how to keep the mud outside where it belongs.

1



Dress for the Weather

Raincoat, galoshes and a hat. You will be going out several times.

2



Let It Splash

Let the dinosaur enjoy the puddles. A good splash now means a calm evening.

3



Hose Off the Mud

When the rain stops, hose the mud off its legs before it comes near the house.

MATERIALS



A big yellow raincoat



Rubber galoshes



A doormat (the largest you can buy)



Old newspapers



A mop and bucket

4



Lay Down Newspapers

Spread newspapers from the back door to the garage.

5



Wipe the Feet

Have it wipe its feet on the big doormat, one foot at a time.

NOTES

Mud is good for dinosaur skin. A little is fine; a lot belongs outside.



6 *Mop Up*

Mop the porch. Hang the raincoat to dry. Have a cup of cocoa.

HOW TO

KEEPING A STEGOSAURUS COOL IN A HEAT WAVE

SKILL 21 · WATER AND BATH TIME · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Stegosaurs use their back plates to cool off, but on a 100-degree day the plates need help. Here is how to keep a big dinosaur comfortable in the summer heat.

MATERIALS

- A lawn sprinkler



- A big canvas awning



- A block of ice



- Watermelons, several



- An electric fan (the big one)



1



Set Up Some Shade

Stretch a canvas awning from the garage to a tree. Shade is the first comfort.

2



Turn On the Sprinkler

Set a sprinkler where the plates will catch the spray.

3

Serve Cold Watermelon

Chilled watermelon is food and water in one. Serve whole.



4



Place a Block of Ice

Set a block of ice in the shade for it to lie against.

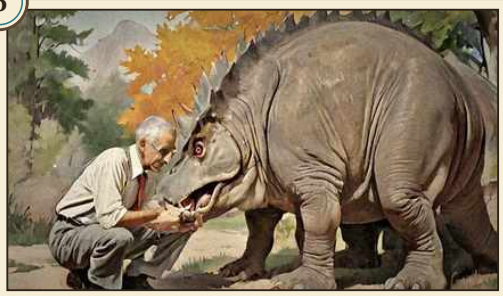
5



Run the Fan

Point the big fan at its plates. The steam that comes off is perfectly normal.

6



Check on It Often

Look in every hour. A cool dinosaur lies flat and sighs. A hot one pants.

NOTES

Fill the stock tank with cool water twice a day in summer.

IMPORTANT

Never hose a hot dinosaur with ice-cold water all at once. Cool it gradually.

CHAPTER FOUR

4

HOME AND SHELTER

Where it sleeps, where it waits, and where it is not allowed







Every dinosaur needs a place of its own: somewhere dry to sleep, somewhere shady to nap, and a clear understanding of which rooms are off limits. With a few weekends of work, the old garage, a sturdy fence and some firm house rules will give your dinosaur a home and give you your living room back.

IN THIS CHAPTER

22 Turning the Garage Into a Dino-House
23 Building Fences That Actually Work
24 Bedtime: Tucking In a Triceratops
25 Dinosaur-Proofing the Living Room
26 Protecting the Prize Rose Bushes
27 Sharing the Bathroom

HOW TO

TURNING THE GARAGE INTO A DINO-HOUSE

SKILL 22 · HOME AND SHELTER · 2 WEEKENDS · HARD

The family car can live in the driveway. The garage, with its wide door and concrete floor, makes an ideal dinosaur house.

MATERIALS


A crowbar and a hammer


Ten bales of straw


Lumber for a wider door


A heat lamp


A can of barn-red paint

1



Clear It Out

Move out the car, the lawn mower and twenty years of Father's projects. This is the hardest step.

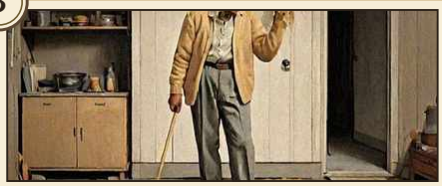
2



Widen the Door

Pry off the trim and frame a wider opening. Horns need clearance.

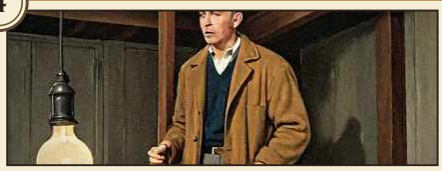
3



Spread the Straw

Lay straw a foot deep. It is warm, soft, and easy to change.

4



Hang a Heat Lamp

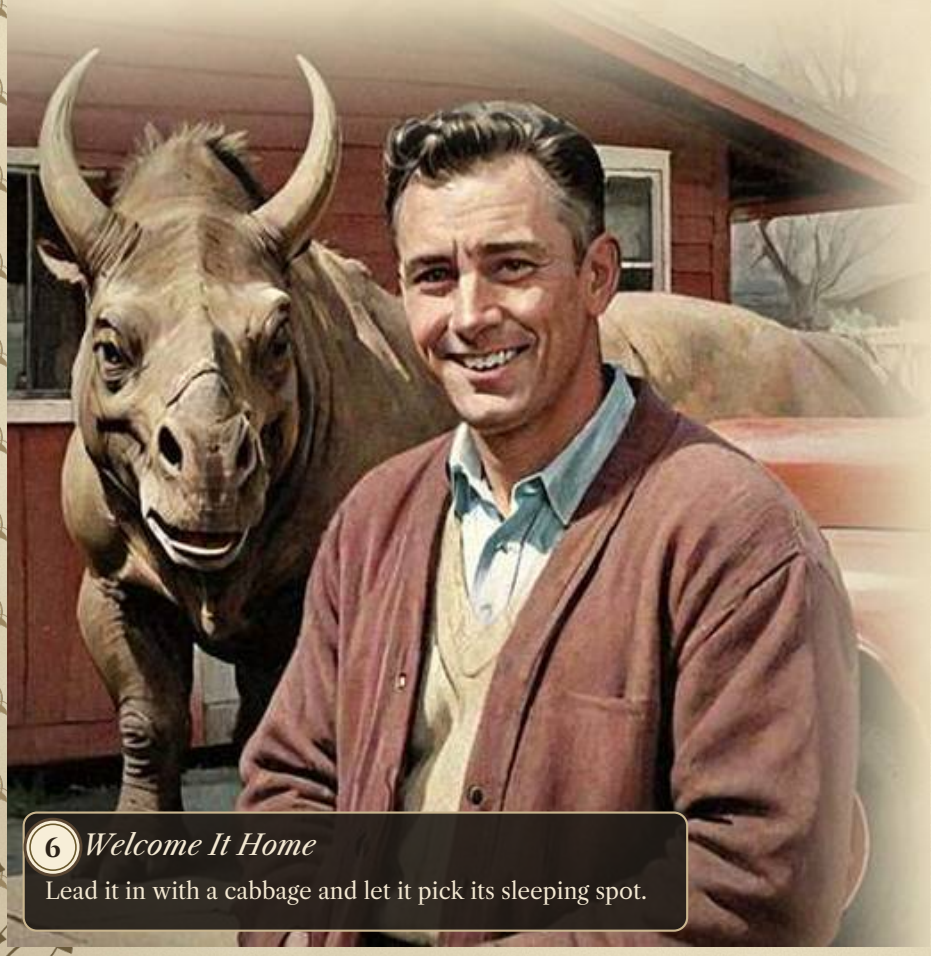
Cold-blooded dinosaurs need warmth at night. Hang the lamp high and out of reach.

5



Paint It Cheerful

A coat of barn-red paint makes it look like a proper home.



6 *Welcome It Home*

Lead it in with a cabbage and let it pick its sleeping spot.

NOTES

Leave the garage radio on low at night. It helps a new dinosaur settle.

IMPORTANT

Keep paint cans, gasoline and lawn chemicals out of the dino-house entirely.

HOW TO

BUILDING FENCES THAT ACTUALLY WORK

SKILL 23 · HOME AND SHELTER · 1 WEEKEND · HARD

A white picket fence is charming. It is also, to a stegosaurus, a snack and a toothpick. A dinosaur fence must be tall, strong and, above all, polite looking.

1



Mark the Line

Run string along the property line and check it with your neighbor. Good fences make good neighbors.

2



Dig Deep Holes

Dig post holes four feet deep. Dinosaurs lean.

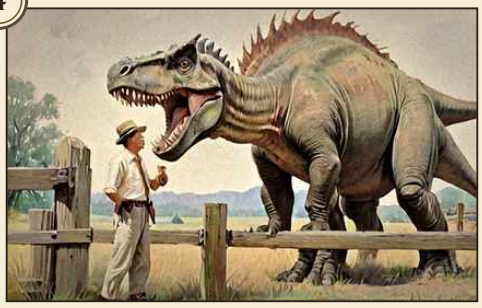
3

Set the Posts in Concrete

Stand railroad ties in the holes and pour concrete around them.



4



Bolt On the Rails

Use heavy timbers, not pickets. Three rails high at least.

5



Paint It White

Paint makes it look like an ordinary fence, which pleases the neighbors and fools the dinosaur.

6



Test It Gently

Let the dinosaur lean on it. If it holds, celebrate with lemonade.

NOTES

A row of sunflowers along the fence hides the timber and gives the dinosaur a treat it can reach over for.

MATERIALS

- Railroad ties for posts



- Heavy timber rails



- A post-hole digger



- Bags of concrete



- White fence paint



HOW TO

BEDTIME: TUCKING IN A TRICERATOPS

SKILL 24 · HOME AND SHELTER · 20 MINUTES · EASY

Dinosaurs, like children, sleep better with a routine. A story, a blanket and a song work as well on three horns as on two pigtails.

MATERIALS


A large patchwork quilt


A picture book


A flashlight


A glass of warm milk (for you)


A nightlight

1



Brush the Straw Smooth

Fluff up its bed. Remove any toys it has carried in.

2



Spread the Quilt

A big patchwork quilt over the back keeps the night chill away.

3



Read a Story

Read something calm. Avoid stories with meteors.

4



Sing a Lullaby

Hum softly. Dinosaurs prefer slow songs.

5



Switch On the Nightlight

A small light keeps it from bumping into things at night.



6 *Tiptoe Out*

Whisper 'Good night' and close the door gently.

NOTES

Leave a familiar-smelling sweater in the straw for a new dinosaur.

HOW TO

DINOSAUR-PROOFING THE LIVING ROOM

SKILL 25 · HOME AND SHELTER · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Sooner or later it will come indoors. A few precautions protect the lamps, the sofa and Grandmother's china figurines.

1



Pack Away the Breakables

Wrap the figurines and the good vase in newspaper and pack them away.

2



Cover the Furniture

Throw blankets over the sofa and armchair. Claws and upholstery do not mix.

3

Latch the Cupboards

Fit latches on low cupboards. Clever dinosaurs open doors.



4



Put Up Gates

Block the stairs and the good front room with sturdy gates.

5



Tape Down the Cords

Tape lamp cords to the floor so nothing gets tripped over or chewed.

6



Give It a Rug of Its Own

A rag rug by the fire becomes its spot, and keeps it off the sofa.

NOTES

Walk through the house at dinosaur eye level. You will spot dangers you never noticed.

MATERIALS

- Packing boxes



- Furniture blankets



- A child safety gate (or three)



- Cupboard latches



- A roll of masking tape



HOW TO

PROTECTING THE PRIZE ROSE BUSHES

SKILL 26 · HOME AND SHELTER · 1 AFTERNOON · EASY

Roses take years to grow and about four seconds to eat. Here is how to defend the garden club entries.

MATERIALS


Wire rose cages


A bag of cayenne pepper


A spray bottle


Garden twine


A folding lawn chair

1



Cage Each Bush

Set a sturdy wire cage over each rose bush and stake it down.

2



Mix a Pepper Spray

Stir cayenne pepper into water. Dinosaurs dislike spicy roses.

3



Spray the Leaves

Mist the outer leaves, not the blooms.

4



Tie Up Long Canes

Tie long canes in so nothing pokes out for a snack.

5



Keep Watch

During the first week, sit with the roses in the evening. Your presence is a fence.



6 *Offer Something Better*

Plant a patch of clover just for the dinosaur. It is cheaper than roses.

NOTES

Armored dinosaurs swing their tails when happy. Keep them well clear of the flower beds.

IMPORTANT

Cayenne stings eyes. Spray with the wind behind you.

HOW TO

SHARING THE BATHROOM

SKILL 27 · HOME AND SHELTER · ONGOING · HARD

Small dinosaurs believe the bathtub is theirs. So do teenagers. This skill helps them share.

1



Post a Schedule

Tape a schedule on the door. Dinosaurs go first; it saves the hot water.

2



Lay a Bath Mat

A rubber mat keeps claws from scratching the tub.

3

Run a Shallow Bath

Ankle deep is plenty for a small dinosaur.



4



Give It Its Own Towel

Mark its towel with a big D. Everyone else will be glad you did.

5



Wipe Down the Tub

Dry off the dinosaur first, then rinse the scales and sand out of the tub.

6



Enjoy Your Turn

Hand the dinosaur its towel and show it the door. Then lock up and enjoy your bath in peace.

NOTES

Keep the toothbrushes in a high cupboard. Dinosaurs think they are toys.

MATERIALS

- A bathroom schedule



- A rubber bath mat



- A dinosaur towel (marked)



- A lock for the door



- A great deal of patience



CHAPTER FIVE

5

TRAINING AND MANNERS

Sit, stay, and please stop eating the hedge







An untrained dinosaur is a nuisance. A trained dinosaur is a marvel, a helper, and the pride of the block. Dinosaurs are cleverer than they look and want very much to please the people who feed them. Patience, treats and a firm, kind voice are all you need to raise a dinosaur the neighbors will brag about.

IN THIS CHAPTER

28 Teaching Sit and Stay
29 Walking on a Leash Around the Neighborhood
30 Housebreaking and the Very Large Shovel
31 Stopping the Roar at Dawn
32 Playing Fetch With a Telephone Pole
33 Teaching a Raptor Not to Open Doors
34 Answering the Doorbell Politely

HOW TO

TEACHING SIT AND STAY

SKILL 28 · TRAINING AND MANNERS · 2 WEEKS · MEDIUM

Every other command builds on 'sit'. A sitting tyrannosaurus is also much less alarming to visitors.

1



Get Its Attention

Hold up a biscuit and say its name. Wait for eye contact.

2



Raise the Treat

Move the biscuit slowly up and back over its head. As its head goes up, its tail end comes down.

3



Say 'Sit' and Click

The moment it sits, say 'Sit!', click, and give the treat.

MATERIALS


A bag of training biscuits


A clicker


A quiet corner of the yard


A whistle


A notebook to track progress

4



Add 'Stay'

With it sitting, hold up your palm, say 'Stay', and take one step back.

5



Back Up Slowly

Each day add one more step. Return and reward.

NOTES

End every lesson with something it already does well, so it finishes proud.



6 ### *Practice Every Day*

Ten minutes, twice a day. Write down progress in your notebook.

HOW TO

WALKING ON A LEASH AROUND THE NEIGHBORHOOD

SKILL 29 · TRAINING AND MANNERS · 30 MINUTES DAILY · MEDIUM

A daily walk keeps a dinosaur fit and calm, and gives the neighbors something to talk about. A well-mannered walk makes it something good.

MATERIALS

- A strong leather leash



- A harness (not a collar)



- A pocketful of treats



- A good pair of walking shoes



- A hat to tip



1



Fit the Harness

A harness around the chest is safer than a collar. Adjust so two fingers fit underneath.

2



Start in the Yard

Practice walking in the yard first. Stop whenever it pulls.

3

Head Down the Sidewalk

Walk at a steady pace. Keep the leash loose and your shoulders back.



4



Tip Your Hat

Greet each neighbor. A friendly hello makes the dinosaur seem friendly too.

5



Pass the Cat Calmly

If it spots a cat, turn and walk the other way with a treat.

6



Reward at Home

Finish with a treat and a drink of water at the gate.

NOTES

Walk the same route at the same time. Dinosaurs love routine and the neighbors will get used to it.

IMPORTANT

Never wrap the leash around your hand. If it bolts after a squirrel, let go.

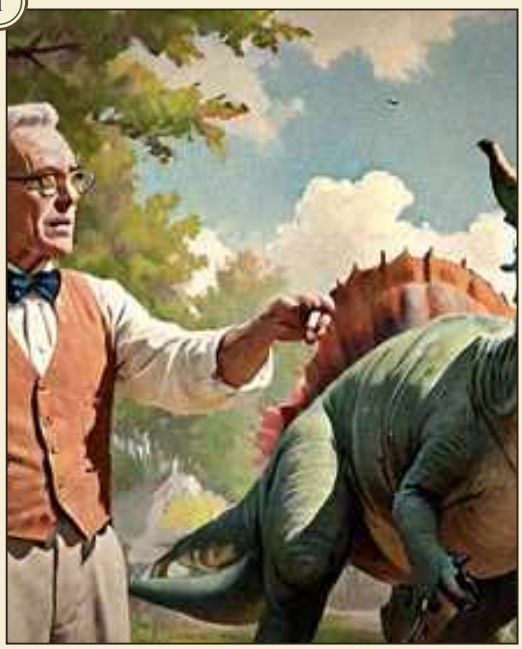
HOW TO

HOUSEBREAKING AND THE VERY LARGE SHOVEL

SKILL 30 · TRAINING AND MANNERS · 1 MONTH · HARD

This is the least glamorous chapter of dinosaur ownership, and the most important. The good news: dinosaur droppings make the finest garden fertilizer in the county.

1



Choose a Spot

Pick one corner of the yard, far from the house and the neighbors' patio.

2



Lead It There After Meals

Walk it to the spot right after every meal and wait.

3



Praise Success

When it uses the spot, praise it lavishly. Dinosaurs love praise.

MATERIALS


A coal shovel (the biggest available)


A wheelbarrow


A clothespin (for the nose)


A compost bin


Rubber boots

4



Shovel Daily

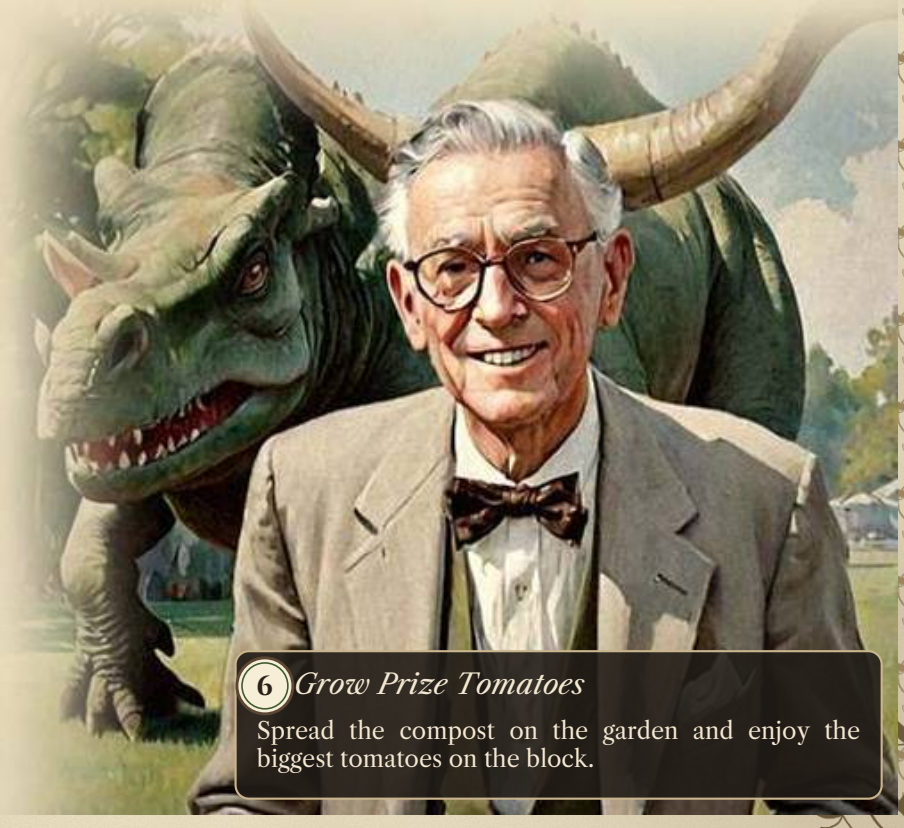
Clean up every morning with the big shovel and the wheelbarrow.

5



Compost It

Pile it in the compost bin. In six months it becomes black gold.



6 ### *Grow Prize Tomatoes*

Spread the compost on the garden and enjoy the biggest tomatoes on the block.

NOTES

Sell surplus compost at the church sale. It funds the lettuce bill.

HOW TO

STOPPING THE ROAR AT DAWN

SKILL 31 · TRAINING AND MANNERS · 2 WEEKS · MEDIUM

Some dinosaurs greet every sunrise with a roar that rattles windows three streets away. The neighbors will appreciate your efforts here more than anything else in this book.

MATERIALS

- Heavy blackout curtains



- An alarm clock



- A radio



- Breakfast, ready early



- Earmuffs (for the family)



1



Find the Cause

Most dawn roars mean 'I'm hungry' or 'I'm bored'. Both can be fixed.

2



Hang Blackout Curtains

Cover the dino-house windows so dawn arrives later.

3

Set Your Alarm Earlier

Get up fifteen minutes before sunrise and serve breakfast before it thinks to roar.



4



Serve Breakfast Quietly

A full mouth cannot roar.

5



Leave the Radio On

Soft morning music keeps it company until the family is up.

6



Reward Quiet Mornings

Give an extra treat on any morning without a roar.

NOTES

Send the neighbors a note and a pie while you work on it. Patience comes easier with pie.

HOW TO

PLAYING FETCH WITH A TELEPHONE POLE

SKILL 32 · TRAINING AND MANNERS · 1 HOUR · EASY

Big dinosaurs need big games. A game of fetch burns off energy, builds friendship and, if done carefully, does not knock down any power lines.

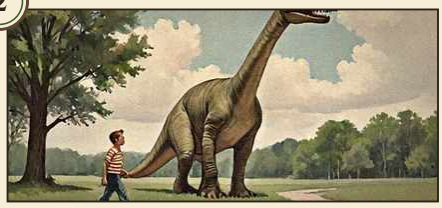
1



Get a Pole

The telephone company often gives away old poles. Ask nicely and offer a ride on the dinosaur.

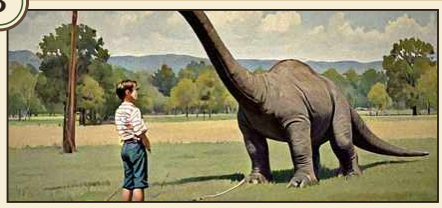
2



Find an Open Field

Go well away from houses, wires and cars. A pasture is perfect.

3



Show It the Pole

Let it sniff and pick up the pole.

MATERIALS


A retired telephone pole (ask the phone company)

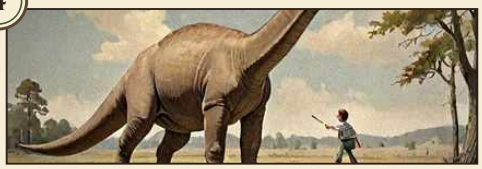

A large open field


Work gloves


A whistle


A thermos of lemonade

4



Point and Say 'Fetch'

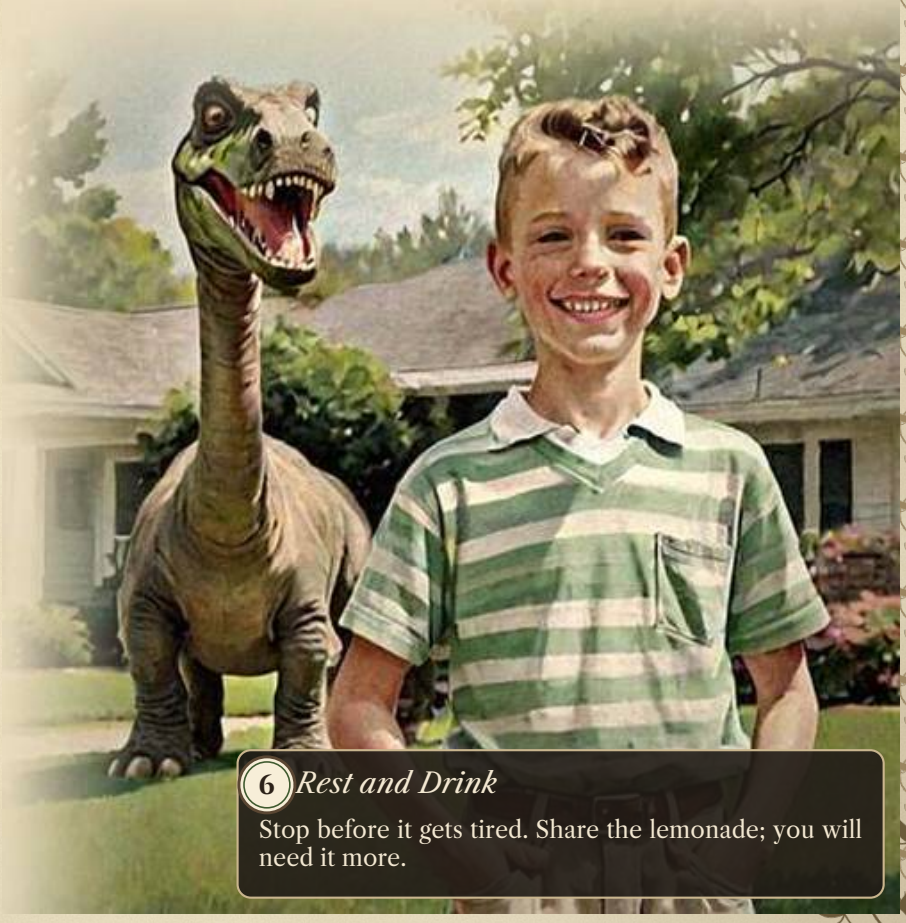
You cannot throw a telephone pole. Point to the far end of the field and say 'Fetch!' It will carry the pole there and back.

5



Reward the Return

When it brings the pole back, cheer and give a treat.



6 *Rest and Drink*

Stop before it gets tired. Share the lemonade; you will need it more.

NOTES

A smaller dinosaur can fetch a broom handle or a fence rail.

IMPORTANT

Never play fetch near power lines or roads.

HOW TO

TEACHING A RAPTOR NOT TO OPEN DOORS

SKILL 33 · TRAINING AND MANNERS · 1 WEEK · HARD

MATERIALS

- Round slippery doorknobs



- Hook-and-eye latches (mounted high)



- A tin of treats



- A small bell



- Petroleum jelly



Velociraptors are terribly clever and learn to turn doorknobs within a week. Unlearning it takes rather longer.

1



Watch How It Does It

Learn its method. Most raptors grab the knob with their jaws and twist.

2



Grease the Knobs

A thin coat of petroleum jelly makes knobs too slippery to turn.

3

Add High Latches

Fit hook-and-eye latches at the top of each outside door.



4



Hang a Bell

A small bell on the door tells you when it is trying again.

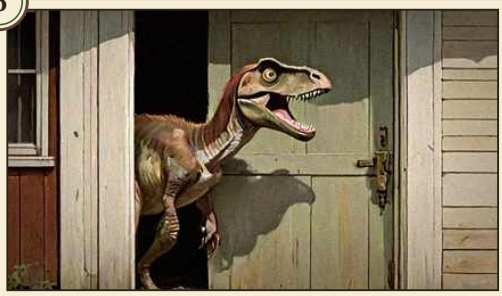
5



Redirect and Reward

When it leaves a door alone, praise it and give a treat.

6



Give It Its Own Door

A flap in the garage door gives it somewhere it is allowed to go.

NOTES

A busy raptor is a good raptor. Give it puzzles: a biscuit in a closed basket keeps it occupied for an hour.

HOW TO

ANSWERING THE DOORBELL POLITELY

SKILL 34 · TRAINING AND MANNERS · 1 WEEK · MEDIUM

Visitors arrive expecting a handshake, not a triceratops. Teach your dinosaur to wait calmly while the family answers the door.

1



Recruit a Neighbor

Ask a neighbor to ring the bell several times a day for a week.

2



Teach 'Go to Your Mat'

Point to a mat a few steps from the door. Reward when it goes there.

3



Ring the Bell

When the bell rings, say 'Mat!' Reward it for going there instead of to the door.

MATERIALS

- A doorbell
- A helpful neighbor
- A bag of treats
- A mat by the door
- A welcome sign

4



Open the Door Slowly

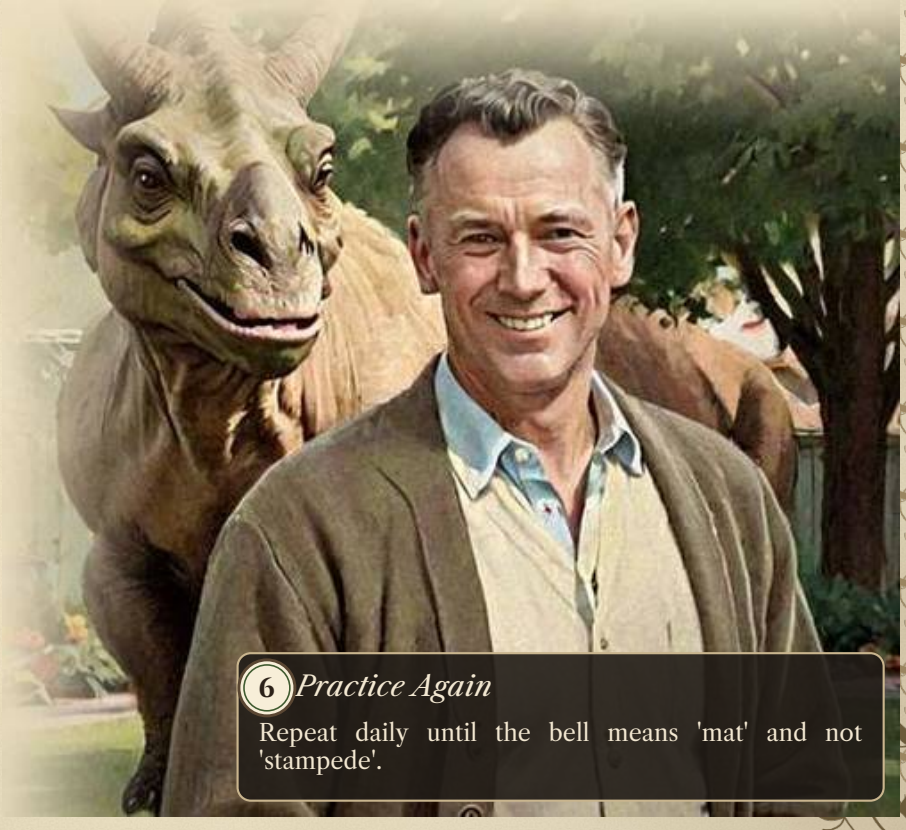
Open just a little at first. Let the visitor see the dinosaur is calm.

5



Introduce the Visitor

Let the visitor offer a treat. Friends are made one biscuit at a time.



6 ### *Practice Again*

Repeat daily until the bell means 'mat' and not 'stampede'.

NOTES

Put a sign on the gate: 'Friendly Dinosaur. Please Ring and Wait.'

CHAPTER SIX

6

HEALTH AND FIRST AID

Sniffles, splinters and calling the very surprised veterinarian



Dinosaurs are hardy creatures; they did, after all, last a hundred and sixty million years. But a modern backyard brings modern troubles: petunias that disagree with them, splinters from the fence and the occasional head cold caught from Junior. Most problems can be handled at home with a calm hand, a big thermometer and a veterinarian who is willing to take your call.

IN THIS CHAPTER

35 The Weekly Health Inspection
36 Calling the Veterinarian (and Convincing Him)
37 Treating a Dinosaur Head Cold
38 Shedding, Molting and Loose Feathers
39 Tummy Trouble After the Neighbor's Petunias
40 Exercise and Keeping Fit

THE WEEKLY HEALTH INSPECTION

SKILL 35 · HEALTH AND FIRST AID · 30 MINUTES · EASY

A quick look over your dinosaur once a week catches small troubles before they become big ones. Make it a Sunday afternoon habit.

1



Look at the Eyes

Eyes should be bright and clear, not cloudy or runny.

2



Check the Scales

Look for cracked, loose or missing scales, especially along the tail.

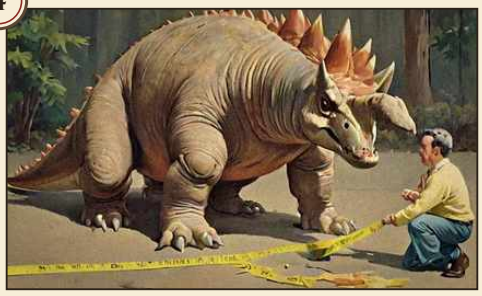
3

Inspect the Plates

Plates should be firm and warm. A wobbly plate needs the vet.



4



Measure Its Growth

Measure from nose to tail once a month and write it down.

5



Watch It Walk

A healthy dinosaur walks evenly. A limp means a sore foot or a splinter.

6



Finish With a Treat

Every checkup ends with a treat, so it looks forward to the next.

NOTES

Keep a health log with the date, length, weight guess and any notes. The vet will love you for it.

MATERIALS

- A clipboard and a checklist



- A flashlight



- A stepladder



- A tape measure



- A bag of treats



HOW TO

CALLING THE VETERINARIAN (AND CONVINCING HIM)

SKILL 36 · HEALTH AND FIRST AID · 1 TELEPHONE CALL · MEDIUM

Most veterinarians have never treated a dinosaur and are not sure they want to. A calm, well-prepared phone call will win them over.

MATERIALS


The telephone


Your health log


A photograph of the dinosaur


A pot of coffee


Directions to your house

1



Gather Your Notes

Have the health log open before you call. Facts reassure a nervous vet.

2



Start Calmly

Begin with 'I have a large patient with a small problem.' Do not open with 'dinosaur'.

3



Describe the Trouble

Give symptoms clearly: what, since when, and how often.

4



Offer a House Call

Explain that the patient does not fit in the waiting room.

5



Greet the Vet Warmly

Have coffee ready. Most vets need a cup when they first see the patient.



6 ### *Hold the Treats*

Keep the dinosaur calm with treats while the doctor works.

NOTES

Large-animal vets who treat horses and cows are usually the most willing to help.

TREATING A DINOSAUR HEAD COLD

SKILL 37 · HEALTH AND FIRST AID · 3 TO 5 DAYS · EASY

A dinosaur sneeze can knock the shingles off a roof. Fortunately, a dinosaur cold is treated much like yours: rest, warmth and soup.

1



Take Its Temperature

Use the big thermometer under the arm. A warm dinosaur is a sick dinosaur.

2



Wrap It Up

Drape wool blankets over its back and keep it out of drafts.

3

Serve Soup

A big pot of chicken soup, cooled. Grandmother swears by it.



4



Run the Vaporizer

Steam helps clear its nose. Add a little eucalyptus.

5



Hand Over a Handkerchief

Hold up a bed sheet when a sneeze is coming.

6



Let It Rest

Keep the children from playing with it until the sniffles stop.

NOTES

Dinosaur colds are not catching for people, but people colds may be catching for dinosaurs. Wash your hands.

IMPORTANT

A cough that lasts more than a week, or green spots, needs the vet.

MATERIALS

- A large thermometer



- A big pot of chicken soup



- Wool blankets



- A vaporizer



- Handkerchiefs (bed-sheet size)



SHEDDING, MOLTING AND LOOSE FEATHERS

SKILL 38 · HEALTH AND FIRST AID · 1 SEASON · EASY

Twice a year many dinosaurs shed their skin or feathers. It is perfectly natural and wonderfully messy.

MATERIALS


A soft bristle brush


A bushel basket


A broom and dustpan


Baby oil


A scrapbook

1



Notice the Signs

Dull color, itchy scratching and a grumpy mood mean molting season is here.

2



Brush Gently

Brush with the feathers to lift loose ones away.

3



Collect the Feathers

Gather them in a basket. They make wonderful pillow stuffing.

4



Oil Dry Patches

Rub a little baby oil on dry, flaky skin.

5



Sweep Up

Sweep the porch daily during the molt.



6 *Save the Best*

Press the prettiest feathers in a scrapbook. They are worth a great deal to museums.

NOTES

Feathers make excellent show-and-tell items. See Chapter 7.

TUMMY TROUBLE AFTER THE NEIGHBOR'S PETUNIAS

SKILL 39 · HEALTH AND FIRST AID · 1 DAY · MEDIUM

Petunias, azaleas and Mr. Peterson's prize hedge do not agree with dinosaur stomachs. Here is what to do when it has eaten something it should not have.

1



Find Out What It Ate

Look over the fence. The missing plants usually tell the story.

2



Serve Plain Oatmeal

A bland meal of oatmeal settles the stomach.

3

Offer Peppermint

Fresh peppermint leaves calm a rumbling tummy.



4



Apply a Hot Water Bottle

A warm bottle on the belly helps, if it will lie still.

5



Replant the Neighbor's Bed

Replace what was eaten. It is the neighborly thing to do.

6



Deliver an Apology

A handwritten note and a pie mend most fences.

NOTES

See the Backyard Plants chart in the appendix for what is safe and what is not.

IMPORTANT

If it has eaten anything metal, or anything that was moving, call the vet.

MATERIALS

- A bucket of plain oatmeal



- Peppermint leaves



- A hot water bottle (large)



- A garden spade



- A letter of apology



EXERCISE AND KEEPING FIT

SKILL 40 · HEALTH AND FIRST AID · 1 HOUR DAILY · EASY

A bored dinosaur finds its own exercise, usually in somebody else's yard. Regular activity keeps it trim, cheerful and close to home.

MATERIALS


A large rubber ball (a beach ball works)


A jump rope


A stopwatch


A whistle


A portable record player

1



Warm Up

A slow walk around the yard loosens stiff legs.

2



Play Ball

Roll a beach ball. Duck-bills love to nudge it back with their snouts.

3



Dance to a Record

Put on a lively record. Many dinosaurs enjoy a hop to Bill Haley.

4



Time the Laps

Time a lap around the block with a stopwatch and try to beat it each week.

5



Cool Down

Walk slowly and give plenty of water.



6 *Rest Together*

Lie in the grass and enjoy the sunshine.

NOTES

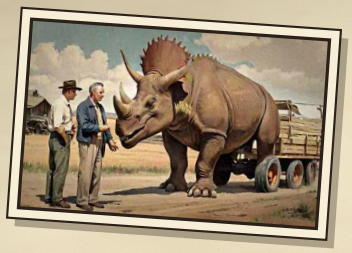
Twice-daily exercise is the best cure for midnight roaring.

CHAPTER SEVEN

7

OUT AND ABOUT

Taking your dinosaur into town, to the beach, and to school







A dinosaur should not spend its whole life in the backyard. Outings are good for its mind and for the community, which will soon get used to seeing it at the drive-in and the grocery store. With planning and good manners, your dinosaur can go almost anywhere a family goes. Except the bowling alley. Never the bowling alley.

IN THIS CHAPTER

41 The Family Road Trip
42 A Day at the Beach
43 Show and Tell at School
44 Visiting the Grocery Store
45 A Night at the Drive-In Movie
46 The County Fair and the Church Picnic
47 Camping With a Dinosaur

HOW TO

THE FAMILY ROAD TRIP

SKILL 41 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 VACATION · HARD

There is nothing like seeing America together. A dinosaur makes the trip longer, but the stories better.

MATERIALS

- A flatbed trailer



- Heavy straps



- A road atlas



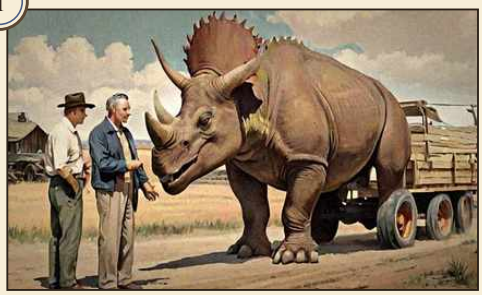
- Snacks for everybody



- A big canvas tarp



1



Rent a Trailer

A flatbed farm trailer is the only practical choice for anything larger than a pony.

2



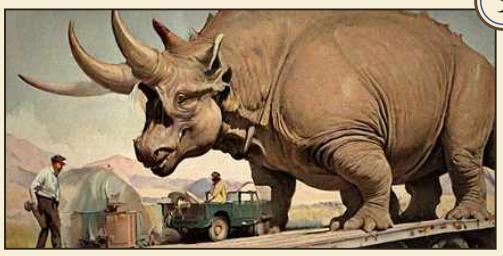
Load With a Ramp

Lay planks for a ramp and walk it up with a cabbage.

3

Check the Load

Walk round the trailer before you drive. Straps over its back: snug, not tight.



4



Plan the Route

Pick back roads. Highway patrolmen want a word at every state line.

5



Stop Every Two Hours

Stop for stretches, water and photographs. Crowds will gather.

6



Enjoy the Sights

Smile and wave. You are now one of the sights.

NOTES

Bring a tarp for rain. Dinosaurs dislike wet trips more than you do.

IMPORTANT

Check the bridge weight limits before crossing anything old.

HOW TO

A DAY AT THE BEACH

SKILL 42 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 DAY · EASY

Dinosaurs love the beach, though the beach is not always sure about the dinosaur. Go early, choose a quiet stretch, and bring a very large towel.

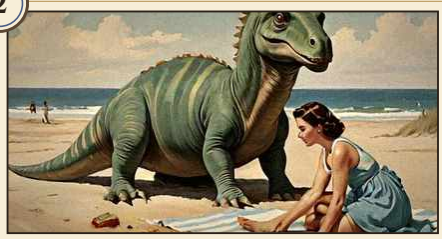
1



Arrive Early

Get there before the crowds and claim a wide stretch of sand.

2



Spread the Towel

Lay out the towel. The dinosaur will lie on it. Bring a second towel for you.

3



Splash in the Shallows

Let it paddle where the waves are small.

MATERIALS


A beach umbrella


A very large towel


A picnic basket


Suntan lotion


A sand bucket and spade

4



Dig in the Sand

Dinosaurs love to dig. Let it dig a hole you can swim in.

5



Have a Picnic

Sandwiches for you, a crate of watermelons for it.

NOTES

Duck-billed dinosaurs body-surf beautifully. Long-necks should stay knee-deep.



6 *Rinse Off*

Rinse the salt off at the beach shower before the drive home.

HOW TO

SHOW AND TELL AT SCHOOL

SKILL 43 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 MORNING · MEDIUM

No child in history has had a better show-and-tell. A little planning makes sure it is remembered for the right reasons.

MATERIALS

- A permission note from the principal



- A wagon



- A blanket



- Flash cards with dinosaur facts



- Cookies for the class



1



Ask Permission First

Get a signed note from the principal. Teachers do not like surprises of this kind.

2



Practice Your Talk

Write three facts on cards. Practice at the breakfast table.

3

Bring It in a Wagon

A small dinosaur rides nicely in a red wagon with a blanket.



4



Stand at the Front

Stand beside it at the front of the class and speak clearly.

5



Answer Questions

There will be many questions. 'Does it bite?' is always first.

6



Share the Cookies

Pass round cookies. Save one for the dinosaur.

NOTES

Larger dinosaurs can visit the school playground instead of the classroom.

HOW TO

VISITING THE GROCERY STORE

SKILL 44 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 HOUR · HARD

Some errands cannot wait. If the dinosaur must come along, a few rules keep the cereal aisle standing.

1



Call the Manager

Ask the manager for a quiet time. Tuesday at opening is best.

2



Keep a Short Leash

Keep it close at your side. Aisles are narrow.

3



Stick to the List

Shop quickly. A lingering dinosaur starts browsing.

MATERIALS


A short leash


A shopping list


A pocket of treats


The store manager's blessing


Exact change

4



Skip the Meat Counter

Go round by the bakery. Trust this book.

5



Pay Promptly

Have exact change ready. The cashier will be distracted.

NOTES

Many stores now deliver. For large dinosaurs, telephone your order in.

IMPORTANT

Never take a hungry dinosaur shopping. Feed it first.



6 *Thank the Manager*

Thank the manager on the way out. You will want to come back.

HOW TO

A NIGHT AT THE DRIVE-IN MOVIE

SKILL 45 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 EVENING · EASY

The drive-in is the ideal outing for a big dinosaur: outdoors, dark and full of popcorn. Just park in the back row.

MATERIALS

- The family car



- Ten pounds of popcorn



- A thermos of cocoa



- A blanket



- A flashlight



1



Park in the Back Row

A long neck blocks the screen for everybody behind you.

2



Hang the Speaker

Hook the speaker on the window and turn it low.

3

Pass the Popcorn

One bucket for you, one washtub for the dinosaur.



4



Pick a Gentle Film

Comedies and musicals are best. Avoid monster pictures; they cause arguments.

5



Share the Blanket

Evenings get cool. A blanket over the shoulders helps.

6



Drive Home Slowly

Drive home slowly with the dinosaur walking behind.

NOTES

The drive-in manager may let you in free. A dinosaur is good advertising.

HOW TO

THE COUNTY FAIR AND THE CHURCH PICNIC

SKILL 46 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 DAY · MEDIUM

Your dinosaur will be the star of every fair and picnic. Here is how to make it a happy day rather than a stampede.

1



Groom for the Show

Brush and polish the plates the night before.

2



Hang Its Name

A painted sign helps children learn its name, so they can say hello properly.

3



Enter the Livestock Show

The judges will not know what category it belongs in. That is their problem.

MATERIALS


A blue-ribbon rosette


A grooming kit



A sign with its name


A sack lunch


A lawn chair

4



Meet the Children

One child at a time, and only with you holding the rope. Rides come later.

5



Collect the Ribbon

Win or lose, pin a ribbon on. It has earned it.

NOTES

Ask the fair to set up a separate dinosaur pen next to the cattle barn.



6 *Rest in the Shade*

Fairs are tiring. Find a shady tree and share a sandwich.

HOW TO

CAMPING WITH A DINOSAUR

SKILL 47 · OUT AND ABOUT · 1 WEEKEND · MEDIUM

Camping with a dinosaur is camping with a built-in bodyguard. Bears give your campsite a very wide berth.

MATERIALS

- A canvas tent



- A camp stove



- Sleeping bags



- A lantern



- Marshmallows (many)



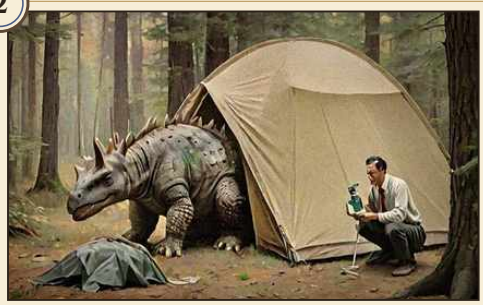
1



Pick a Big Campsite

Choose a clearing with room for a dinosaur to curl up.

2



Pitch the Tent

Set the tent where the dinosaur can see it. It will guard it.

3

Build a Small Fire

Keep the fire small and well away from its tail.



4



Toast Marshmallows

Dinosaurs cannot hold sticks, so toast theirs for them.

5



Tell Stories

Tell gentle stories. Dinosaurs are frightened of ghost stories.

6



Sleep Soundly

Nothing will bother your camp tonight.

NOTES

Leave no trace: pack out what you pack in, and fill in what the dinosaur dug.

IMPORTANT

Put out every fire completely with water, then stir and water again.

CHAPTER EIGHT

8

UNUSUAL SITUATIONS

Storms, snow, escapes, and the day there were suddenly twelve







Even the best-run dinosaur household will face the unexpected. The laundry flies away. The snow comes early. The dinosaur gets out and is seen in front of the bank. None of these is a disaster if you know what to do. This chapter is your calm voice in a crisis.

IN THIS CHAPTER

48 When the Pterodactyl Steals the Laundry
49 Winter: Keeping a Cold-Blooded Pet Warm
50 Thunderstorms and Frightened Dinosaurs
51 When Your Dinosaur Gets Loose Downtown
52 Hatching Day: When There Are Suddenly Twelve
53 The Mailman Standoff
54 Dinosaurs and the New Baby

HOW TO

WHEN THE PTERODACTYL STEALS THE LAUNDRY

SKILL 48 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Flying dinosaurs find a clothesline full of flapping sheets irresistible. Here is how to get your sheets back, and keep them.

MATERIALS


A laundry basket

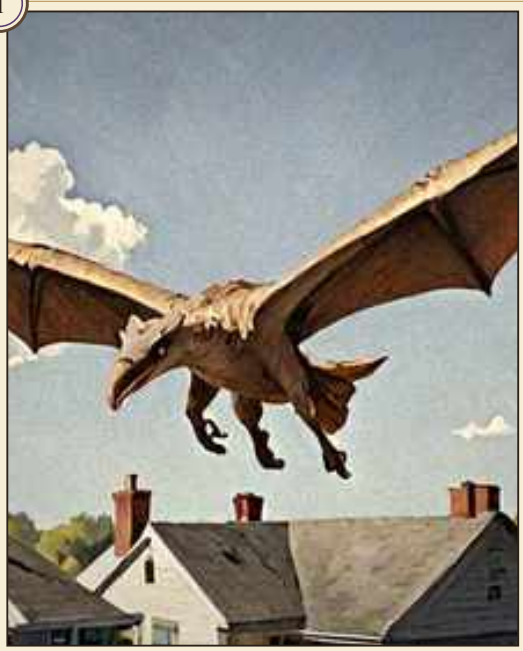

Wooden clothespins (the strong kind)


A tall stepladder


A bag of sardines


A garden net

1



Don't Chase It

You cannot outrun a pterodactyl. Stand still and watch where it lands.

2



Follow to the Roost

It will take the sheet to the highest spot nearby, usually the church steeple or your roof.

3



Trade for Sardines

Hold up a sardine. Pterodactyls drop almost anything for fish.

4



Catch the Sheet

Hold the laundry basket under it as it falls.

5



Use Strong Pins

Pin everything twice with heavy wooden pins.



6 ### *Net the Line*

Drape a garden net over the line on windy days.

NOTES

Give it an old sheet of its own. It will leave the good ones alone.

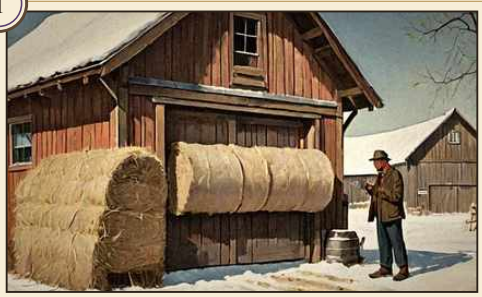
HOW TO

WINTER: KEEPING A COLD-BLOODED PET WARM

SKILL 49 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 1 WINTER · HARD

Dinosaurs evolved in a warm world and take a dim view of snow. When the thermometer drops, they need help staying warm and cheerful.

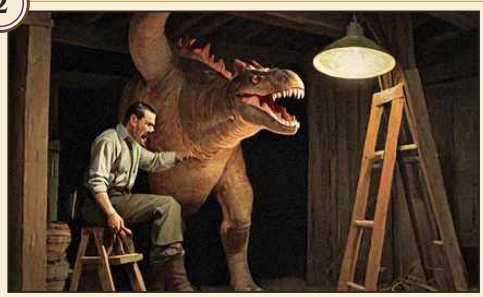
1



Insulate the Dino-House

Stack straw bales around the walls for insulation.

2



Hang Extra Heat Lamps

Add a second heat lamp on the coldest nights.

3

Knit a Scarf

The whole family can knit a section. It takes about forty balls of yarn.



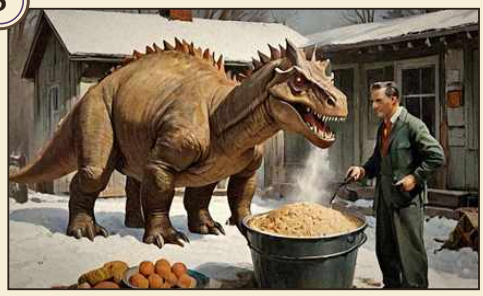
4



Shovel a Path

Clear a path from the barn to the house so it can come for breakfast.

5



Serve Warm Mash

Warm oatmeal mash in the morning heats it from the inside.

6



Short Walks Only

Take short sunny walks at midday and return before it stiffens.

NOTES

Dinosaurs make slow, enormous snow angels. Let them, then warm them up right away.

IMPORTANT

Never use an open fire or kerosene heater in the dino-house.

MATERIALS

- Heat lamps



- Straw bales



- A giant knitted scarf



- Hot water bottles



- A snow shovel



HOW TO

THUNDERSTORMS AND FRIGHTENED DINOSAURS

SKILL 50 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 1 STORMY NIGHT · MEDIUM

A dinosaur that faces down a bear will hide under the porch at the first rumble of thunder. Here is how to comfort it.

MATERIALS


A flashlight

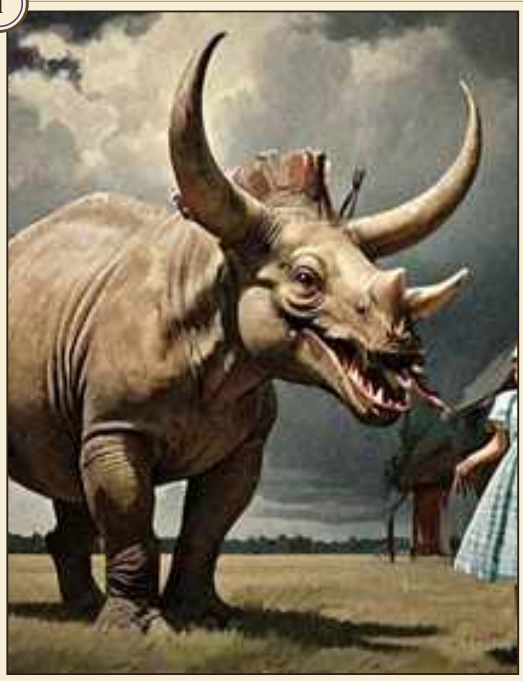

A portable radio


A favorite blanket


A bag of treats


Patience

1



Bring It Inside Early

Watch the sky. Bring it into the barn before the first thunder.

2



Close the Doors

Shut the doors and windows to muffle the noise.

3



Turn Up the Radio

Gentle music covers the thunder.

4



Sit Close By

Sit beside it and speak softly. Your calm is catching.

5



Cover It With Its Blanket

A familiar blanket feels like a safe den.



6 *Wait Out the Storm*

Read a book together until the rain stops.

NOTES

Practice with thunderstorm sounds on a record at low volume on sunny days.

HOW TO

WHEN YOUR DINOSAUR GETS LOOSE DOWNTOWN

SKILL 51 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 1 AFTERNOON · HARD

It happens to the best of families. The gate is left open and twenty minutes later the radio says something about Main Street. Act quickly and calmly.

1



Listen to the Radio

The radio will tell you where it is faster than any search.

2



Load the Cabbages

Put a bushel of cabbages in the car. You will need them.

3

Drive Downtown

Drive carefully. The streets will be busy with people looking up.



4



Whistle and Wave a Cabbage

Stand where it can see you and hold up a cabbage.

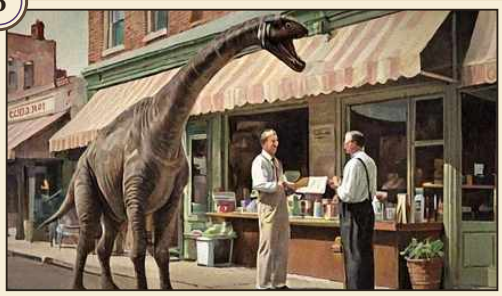
5



Lead It Home

Walk it home slowly down the middle of the street, waving to everybody.

6



Pay for the Awning

There is always an awning. Pay for it promptly and with good grace.

NOTES

Put a padlock on the gate and give everyone in the family a key.

MATERIALS

- The car keys



- A bushel of cabbages



- The leash



- A loud whistle



- Your checkbook



HOW TO

HATCHING DAY: WHEN THERE ARE SUDDENLY TWELVE

SKILL 52 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · 1 WEEK · HARD

You were told it was a boy. It was not. One morning there is a nest under the porch and the next there are twelve hatchlings in the kitchen.

MATERIALS


A large playpen


Twelve baby bottles


A chalkboard for names


An apron with big pockets


Help from the neighbors

1



Count Them

Count twice. Then count again. Hatchlings move.

2



Set Up a Playpen

A big playpen keeps them in one room.

3



Line Up the Bottles

Fill all twelve bottles at once. Feeding is an assembly line.

4



Name Them on a Chalkboard

Write their names on a chalkboard with a mark for each feeding.

5



Call In Helpers

Neighbors who said they love babies can prove it now.



6 ### *Find Good Homes*

Keep one or two. Give the rest to good families, the zoo, or the museum.

NOTES

Ask the newspaper to run a notice: 'Free to Good Home: Dinosaurs, Very Small (For Now).'

HOW TO

THE MAILMAN STANDOFF

SKILL 53 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · ONGOING · MEDIUM

Every dinosaur and every mailman must come to an understanding. Until they do, your mail may arrive by being thrown over the hedge.

1



Move the Mailbox

Put the mailbox at the curb, outside the gate.

2



Introduce Them

Let them meet through the fence with you there.

3

Let Him Give a Treat

Ask the mailman to toss a biscuit each morning. Friendship follows.



4



Leave Coffee Out

A thermos of coffee on the gatepost goes a long way.

5



Practice Waiting

Teach the dinosaur to sit when the mail truck stops.

6



Celebrate the Truce

Some families report the mailman now walks the dinosaur on his route.

NOTES

Leave the mailman a nice gift at Christmas. He has earned it more than most.

MATERIALS

- A mailbox at the curb



- A tin of dog biscuits



- A friendly note



- A thermos of coffee



- A sturdy gate



HOW TO

DINOSAURS AND THE NEW BABY

SKILL 54 · UNUSUAL SITUATIONS · ONGOING · MEDIUM

A new baby in the house changes everything for a dinosaur. With care, the two will become the best of friends. Many a child has learned to walk holding a horn.

MATERIALS


The baby's blanket


A playpen


A baby carriage


A camera


A comfortable chair on the porch

1



Introduce the Smell

Before the baby comes home, let the dinosaur sniff a blanket the baby has used.

2



First Meeting at a Distance

Sit on the porch with the baby in your arms and let the dinosaur look from the lawn.

3



Keep Its Routine

Feed and walk the dinosaur at the usual times so it does not feel left out.

4



Give It a Job

Dinosaurs make fine baby guards. It will lie beside the carriage all afternoon.

5



Never Leave Them Alone

However gentle, a dinosaur is big. A grown-up must always be there.



6 *Take Pictures*

Take lots of photographs. They will treasure them.

NOTES

Some dinosaurs hum to babies. It sounds like a tuba and works like a lullaby.

IMPORTANT

Always supervise. No exceptions, no matter how sweet it is.

CHAPTER NINE

9

FAMILY LIFE

Chores, birthdays, holidays, and growing up together







In the end a dinosaur is not a pet. It is family. It helps with the chores, comes to the birthday parties, stars in the Christmas photograph and, in its own slow way, watches the children grow up. This last chapter is about the everyday joys of a family with a dinosaur in the backyard.

IN THIS CHAPTER

55 Mowing the Lawn the Dinosaur Way
56 Putting a Brontosaurus to Work Around the House
57 A Dinosaur Birthday Party
58 Christmas Tree Trouble
59 Taking the Family Photograph
60 When It's Time to Say Goodbye

HOW TO

MOWING THE LAWN THE DINOSAUR WAY

SKILL 55 · FAMILY LIFE · 1 HOUR · EASY

Why push a mower when a duck-billed dinosaur will crop the grass to a perfect inch, free of charge?

MATERIALS

- A lawn rake



- Stakes and string



- A lemonade glass



- A deck chair



- A newspaper



1



Stake Out the Lawn

Mark the area to be mowed with stakes and string. Flower beds are not lawn.

2



Show It the Grass

Lead it to one corner and let it start.

3

Guide It in Rows

Walk alongside to keep it in straight rows, like a real mower.



4



Relax

Sit in a deck chair and read the paper. This is the best part.

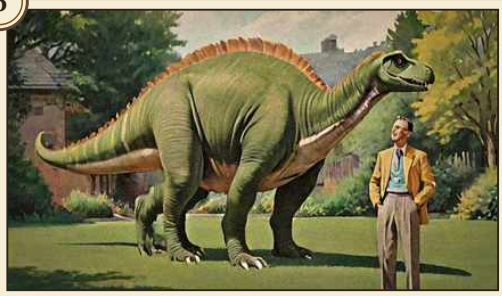
5



Rake the Clippings

Rake up stray clippings. There will not be many.

6



Admire the Result

A perfect lawn. The neighbors will want to borrow your mower.

NOTES

Rent your dinosaur to the neighbors on Saturday mornings. It pays for the lettuce.

HOW TO

PUTTING A BRONTOSAURUS TO WORK AROUND THE HOUSE

SKILL 56 · FAMILY LIFE · 1 SATURDAY · MEDIUM

A long-necked dinosaur can reach where no ladder will. Put it to work and the whole house shines.

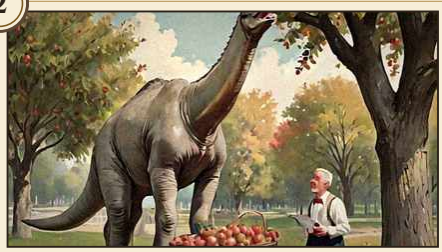
1



Carry the Leaf Basket

Rake the yard and let it carry the basket. It holds the handle gently.

2



Pick the Apples

Hold up the basket; it will drop apples in from the treetop.

3



Wash the Upstairs Windows

Tie a sponge to a broom and let it hold the broom in its mouth.

MATERIALS


A bucket and sponge


A basket for apples


A squeegee


A list of chores


A big bag of treats

4



Fetch the Kite

Every kite in the neighborhood lands in a tree. Now you can get them back.

5



Hang the Bunting

On the Fourth of July, it can hang bunting from the eaves.

NOTES

One job at a time. Long necks get muddled with long lists.



6 *Pay in Treats*

Pay generously. Hard work deserves a reward.

HOW TO

A DINOSAUR BIRTHDAY PARTY

SKILL 57 · FAMILY LIFE · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Whose birthday? Doesn't matter. Children and dinosaurs both love a party, and they are much easier to throw together.

MATERIALS

- A very large cake



- Party hats (one enormous)



- Paper streamers



- Balloons



- Lemonade and a washtub of punch



1



Bake a Big Cake

Bake a sheet cake for the children and a carrot cake the size of a tire for the dinosaur.

2



Decorate the Yard

Streamers on the fence, balloons on the dinosaur's horns.

3

Put On the Hats

A party hat on a triceratops goes between the horns.



4



Sing Happy Birthday

Everybody sings. The dinosaur will join in on the last note.

5



Serve Cake

Children first. Then the dinosaur. Then the grown-ups, if there is any left.

6



Clean Up

Pop the balloons out of earshot. They startle.

NOTES

Invite the neighbors' children. A dinosaur at a birthday party makes friends for life.

HOW TO

CHRISTMAS TREE TROUBLE

SKILL 58 · FAMILY LIFE · 1 DECEMBER · HARD

Bringing a tree indoors is a puzzle for any family with a dinosaur. To a plant-eater, a decorated tree is a gift-wrapped lunch.

1



Buy Two Trees

One for the living room, one for the yard. This is the secret.

2



Decorate the Outdoor Tree First

Put the dinosaur's tree in the yard and decorate it with apples and carrots.

3



Hang the Indoor Ornaments High

Keep ornaments on the upper branches.

MATERIALS


Two Christmas trees


Unbreakable ornaments


Strings of lights


A tree stand


Red ribbon

4



Use Unbreakable Ones

Save the glass ornaments for next year.

5



Tie a Bow on the Dinosaur

A big red ribbon makes it feel part of the celebration.

NOTES

Dinosaurs love tinsel. Do not let them eat it.

IMPORTANT

Unplug tree lights at night and keep them away from straw bedding.



6 *Celebrate Together*

Open presents by the window where it can watch.

HOW TO

TAKING THE FAMILY PHOTOGRAPH

SKILL 59 · FAMILY LIFE · 1 AFTERNOON · MEDIUM

Every year the family lines up for a photograph. With a dinosaur, getting everyone in the frame takes some doing.

MATERIALS

- A camera on a tripod



- Sunday best clothes



- A stepladder for the photographer



- A cabbage for attention



- Patience



1



Choose a Wide Spot

You need a big lawn and the sun behind the photographer.

2



Climb High

Stand on a ladder. You will not get a long neck in the picture from the ground.

3

Pose the Dinosaur First

Get it settled before anyone else lines up.



4



Hold Up a Cabbage

Hold a cabbage by the lens so it looks at the camera.

5



Say Cheese

Count to three and click. Take five more; one will be good.

6



Frame It

Hang the best one in the hall. Send copies to everybody.

NOTES

Have a helper stand behind the camera making silly noises.

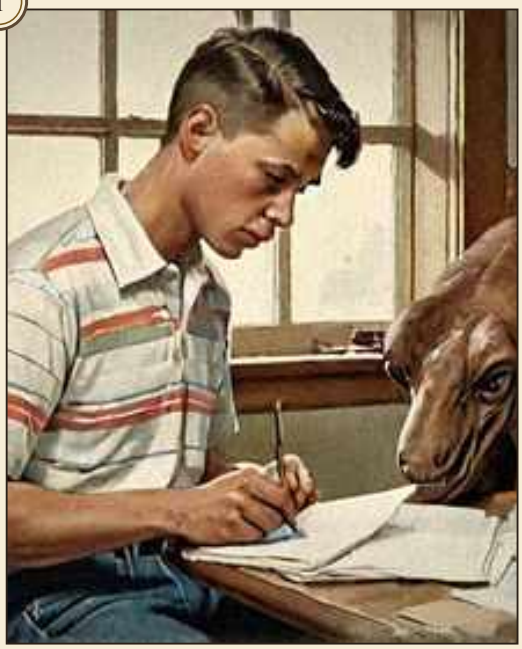
HOW TO

WHEN IT'S TIME TO SAY GOODBYE

SKILL 60 · FAMILY LIFE · 1 DAY · MEDIUM

Some dinosaurs grow too big for any backyard. When yours does, it is time to find it a home with room to roam: a nature reserve, a big ranch, or the valley it came from.

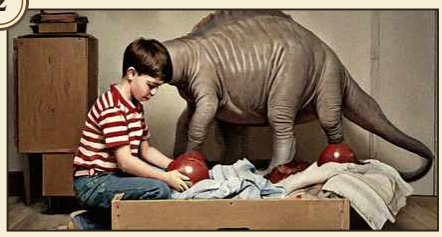
1



Find the Right Place

Write to the state park or a big ranch. Visit first to be sure.

2



Pack Its Things

Its blanket, its ball and a photograph of the family.

3



Take a Last Walk

Walk the old route round the neighborhood. Everyone will come out to wave.

MATERIALS


A suitcase of its favorite things


A long rope halter


A packed lunch


A camera


A handkerchief

4



Travel Together

Go with it all the way. It will feel braver with you there.

5



Say Goodbye

Hug a leg. Promise to visit. Use the handkerchief.



6 *Visit Often*

Come back each summer. It will remember you.

NOTES

Some dinosaurs come home again for Christmas. Leave the garage as it is.

APPENDIX

Charts, checklists and quick references

A. DINOSAUR IDENTIFICATION CHART

Sizes are for a fully grown animal. Yours may still be growing. It is probably still growing.

DINOSAUR	GROWN SIZE	EATS	TEMPERAMENT	GOOD WITH CHILDREN?
Brontosaurus	70 ft, 15 tons	Leaves, lettuce, treetops	Gentle, dreamy	Yes, from a distance
Triceratops	30 ft, 6 tons	Ferns, cabbage, shrubs	Loyal, stubborn	Yes
Stegosaurus	28 ft, 5 tons	Low plants, melons	Calm, slow	Yes
Tyrannosaurus rex	40 ft, 8 tons	Meatloaf, roasts	Proud, hungry	Supervised only
Velociraptor	6 ft, 35 lb	Chicken, hot dogs	Clever, nosy	Older children
Ankylosaurus	25 ft, 5 tons	Low leafy plants	Shy, armored	Yes (mind the tail)
Duck-billed hadrosaur	30 ft, 4 tons	Grass, pine needles	Sociable, noisy	Very good
Pterodactyl	Wingspan 10 ft	Fish, sardines	Mischievous	Watch the laundry

B. DAILY FEEDING AND WATERING CHART

Amounts are for an average grown dinosaur on a mild day. Add a third more water in hot weather. Hatchlings eat every three hours.

DINOSAUR	FOOD PER DAY	WATER PER DAY	TREATS
Hatchling (any)	8 bottles of pea mash	1 gallon	Mashed carrot
Velociraptor	10 lb chicken or hot dogs	3 gallons	Biscuits
Stegosaurus	150 lb greens	60 gallons	Watermelon
Triceratops	200 lb greens	80 gallons	Cabbage hearts
Duck-bill	250 lb grass and greens	100 gallons	Pine cones
Tyrannosaurus rex	100 lb meat (2 meatloaves)	50 gallons	Ham bones
Brontosaurus	1,000 lb leaves and lettuce	300 gallons	Apples by the bushel

C. CHECKLISTS

Copy these pages and tick items off as you get ready. Check the straw and the treat tin every week.

NEW DINOSAUR STARTER KIT

- ☐ Large stock tank and a long garden hose
- ☐ Ten bales of straw
- ☐ A heat lamp
- ☐ Two wheelbarrows
- ☐ A strong harness and leash
- ☐ A coal shovel and compost bin
- ☐ A big scrub brush and washtub
- ☐ Training biscuits (see recipe)
- ☐ A notebook for the health log
- ☐ The veterinarian's telephone number
- ☐ A tape measure (the long kind)
- ☐ A friendly letter for the neighbors

DINOSAUR GO-BAG (FOR OUTINGS)

- ☐ Leash and harness
- ☐ Bag of treats
- ☐ Water jug and bucket
- ☐ A big towel
- ☐ Cleanup shovel and sacks
- ☐ A copy of its name card
- ☐ First-aid kit and thermometer
- ☐ A blanket
- ☐ Snacks for the family
- ☐ Your checkbook (awnings)

BEFORE THE IN-LAWS VISIT

- ☐ Feed the dinosaur early
- ☐ Lock the pantry
- ☐ Hide the good china
- ☐ Hose the mud off
- ☐ Put a bow on it
- ☐ Close the kitchen window
- ☐ Practice 'Mat!' at the door
- ☐ Bake an extra pie
- ☐ Warn the in-laws (gently)

D. BACKYARD PLANTS: SAFE OR NOT?

When in doubt, keep it out. If your dinosaur eats something from the 'No' list, see Tummy Trouble in Chapter 6 and call the vet.

BACKYARD PLANT	SAFE TO EAT?	NOTES
Lettuce, cabbage, kale	Yes	The staple diet
Clover and lawn grass	Yes	Plant a clover patch just for it
Carrots and apples	Yes	Best treats
Sunflowers	Yes	Plant along fences
Pine needles	Yes (duck-bills)	A favorite in winter
Roses	Yes, sadly	Protect with cages
Petunias	No	Upset stomach
Azaleas, rhododendrons	No	Poisonous to most animals
Oleander, foxglove	No	Dangerous; remove from yard
Tomato leaves	No	The fruit is fine; the leaves are not
Rhubarb leaves	No	Stalks fine for pie
The neighbor's hedge	Technically yes	Socially no

E. HANDY DINOSAUR CONVERSIONS

MEASURE	ROUGHLY EQUALS
1 brontosaurus	4 school buses, end to end
1 triceratops	1 farm tractor
1 dinosaur sneeze	A strong summer gust
1 tyrannosaurus roar	Heard 3 streets away
1 day of lettuce (brontosaurus)	1 pickup truck, heaped
1 dinosaur footprint	1 small bathtub
1 dinosaur nap	4 to 6 hours
1 garden hose, full blast	About 10 gallons a minute
300 gallons of water	30 minutes of hose time
1 stock tank (round, 8 ft)	About 700 gallons
1 bale of straw	About 40 lb
1 bushel of cabbages	About 50 lb

F. FAMILY DINOSAUR CARD

Fill this in together and pin a copy by the telephone and inside the garage door.

Dinosaur's name	
Kind of dinosaur	
Date it arrived (or hatched)	
Length today	
Favorite food	
Foods it must never have	
Where it sleeps	
Words it knows	
Who feeds it, and when	
Veterinarian	
Neighbors who don't mind	
Gate padlock key kept at	

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Large-animal veterinarian	
Butcher (standing order)	
Grocer (lettuce by the crate)	
Natural history museum	
Telephone company (old poles)	
Neighbor	
Neighbor	

G. GLOSSARY

Brontosaurus. A very large, long-necked plant-eating dinosaur. Gentle, slow, and impossible to hide.

Clicker. A small metal noisemaker used in training to mark the exact moment of good behavior.

Cold-blooded. Taking body heat from the surroundings. Why dinosaurs love heat lamps and dislike January.

Compost. Rotted plant matter and manure. Dinosaur compost is famous among gardeners.

Dino-house. A garage, barn or shed made over for a dinosaur to sleep in.

Frill. The bony shield behind a triceratops's head. Not a handle.

Hadrosaur. A duck-billed dinosaur. Excellent swimmer and lawn mower.

Hatchling. A newly hatched dinosaur. Small, loud and always hungry.

Herbivore. A plant-eater. Most backyard dinosaurs are herbivores, thank goodness.

Carnivore. A meat-eater. Feed it on time, every time.

Imprinting. When a hatchling decides the first face it sees is its mother.

Molting. Shedding old feathers or skin, usually twice a year.

Plates. The tall bony panels along a stegosaurus's back. They help it warm up and cool down.

Pterodactyl. A flying reptile with leathery wings. Not strictly a dinosaur, but try telling it that.

Stock tank. A large round metal water trough, sold at farm stores.

Thagomizer. The spiky end of a stegosaurus's tail. Stand well clear.

Tyrannosaurus rex. A large meat-eating dinosaur with small arms and a big appetite.

Velociraptor. A small, clever, feathered meat-eater. Can open doors.

H. WHERE TO LEARN MORE

- **Real dinosaurs:** your nearest natural history museum. Most have fossil halls, and the staff love questions from children.
- **Digging for fossils:** many state parks and museums run family fossil digs in the summer. Ask at the visitor center.
- **Big animals:** a county fair livestock barn or a farm open day is the closest thing to dinosaur keeping you can try today.
- **Gardening:** your state's cooperative extension office can tell you which backyard plants are poisonous to pets and livestock.
- **Reading:** the dinosaur shelf at your public library. Bring a wagon.

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MY SKILLS LOG

Tick off each skill once your family has done it. Dinosaurs may not tick their own boxes.

#	SKILL	DATE TRIED	DONE
01	Confirming It's Really a Dinosaur		☐
02	Saying Hello Without Becoming Lunch		☐
03	Identifying Your Dinosaur at a Glance		☐
04	Finding an Egg in the Vegetable Patch		☐
05	Telling the Neighbors		☐
06	When It Comes Through the Kitchen Window		☐
07	Planning a Week of Meals for a Plant-Eater		☐
08	Feeding a Meat-Eater Without Losing the Mailman		☐
09	Hand-Feeding a New Hatchling		☐
10	Grocery Shopping for Four Tons of Lettuce		☐
11	Keeping It Out of the Vegetable Garden		☐
12	Dinner Party Etiquette With a Dinosaur Present		☐
13	Treats and Training Biscuits		☐
14	The Thanksgiving Turkey Problem		☐
15	Watering a Brontosaurus With the Garden Hose		☐
16	Bath Day in the Washtub		☐
17	The Backyard Swimming Pool Takeover		☐
18	Brushing Teeth the Size of Bananas		☐
19	Pedicures for Three-Toed Feet		☐
20	Rainy Day Puddle Management		☐
21	Keeping a Stegosaurus Cool in a Heat Wave		☐
22	Turning the Garage Into a Dino-House		☐
23	Building Fences That Actually Work		☐
24	Bedtime: Tucking In a Triceratops		☐
25	Dinosaur-Proofing the Living Room		☐
26	Protecting the Prize Rose Bushes		☐
27	Sharing the Bathroom		☐
28	Teaching Sit and Stay		☐
29	Walking on a Leash Around the Neighborhood		☐
30	Housebreaking and the Very Large Shovel		☐
31	Stopping the Roar at Dawn		☐
32	Playing Fetch With a Telephone Pole		☐
33	Teaching a Raptor Not to Open Doors		☐
34	Answering the Doorbell Politely		☐
35	The Weekly Health Inspection		☐
36	Calling the Veterinarian (and Convincing Him)		☐
37	Treating a Dinosaur Head Cold		☐
38	Shedding, Molting and Loose Feathers		☐

#	SKILL	DATE TRIED	DONE
39	Tummy Trouble After the Neighbor's Petunias		☐
40	Exercise and Keeping Fit		☐
41	The Family Road Trip		☐
42	A Day at the Beach		☐
43	Show and Tell at School		☐
44	Visiting the Grocery Store		☐
45	A Night at the Drive-In Movie		☐
46	The County Fair and the Church Picnic		☐
47	Camping With a Dinosaur		☐
48	When the Pterodactyl Steals the Laundry		☐
49	Winter: Keeping a Cold-Blooded Pet Warm		☐
50	Thunderstorms and Frightened Dinosaurs		☐
51	When Your Dinosaur Gets Loose Downtown		☐
52	Hatching Day: When There Are Suddenly Twelve		☐
53	The Mailman Standoff		☐
54	Dinosaurs and the New Baby		☐
55	Mowing the Lawn the Dinosaur Way		☐
56	Putting a Brontosaurus to Work Around the House		☐
57	A Dinosaur Birthday Party		☐
58	Christmas Tree Trouble		☐
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NOTES

Your dinosaur's growth, favorite foods, funny moments and things you will never do again.

THE BOOK EVERY DINOSAUR FAMILY NEEDS

It starts with a footprint in the tomato patch. By suppertime there is a triceratops in the garage, the neighbors are on the telephone and nobody can find the garden hose. Every year more American families wake up to find a dinosaur in the backyard, and almost none of them know what to do next.

There's a Dinosaur in the Backyard is here to help: sixty sensible skills, each laid out on a single page with a picture for every step, a materials panel and notes on what can go wrong. Tabs on every page help you find what you need, even while something large is eating the porch.

INSIDE YOU WILL LEARN HOW TO

- Say hello without becoming lunch
- Hatch an egg found in the squash patch
- Feed a meat-eater and keep the mailman
- Water a brontosaurus with the hose
- Brush teeth the size of bananas
- Turn the garage into a dino-house
- Teach sit, stay and polite doorbells
- Cure a sneeze that lifts shingles
- Take it to the drive-in and the beach
- Survive the day there are suddenly twelve



"A fed dinosaur is a friendly dinosaur."

OLD BACKYARD SAYING

THERE'S A DINOSAUR IN THE BACKYARD

Family / Pets (Large) / Humor

FUN BOOKS · HOME EDITION